

ENGLISH FOR THE BUILT ENVIRONMENT

Construction and Architecture English

Clarify the intent. Coordinate the work.
Document the decision.

Phil Stilwell

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Eight lessons. Eleven extended conversations.

INSIDE THE BOOK

192 vocabulary entries / 128 reusable phrases
220 extended-dialogue turns / 11 transfer exchanges
Word banks and explained answer keys

Upper-intermediate to advanced (B2-C1). For architectural, construction, project coordination, and site-administration teams.

2026 edition

Eight scenarios. Eight skills.

Eight project exchanges: define a room brief, resolve a document discrepancy, qualify a change proposal, update a critical sequence, clarify a safety instruction, report inspection status, hand over a punch list, and separate a delay record from a claim.

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The lookahead still shows a delivery that cannot happen | Explain a constrained sequence and distinguish forecast movement from contractual entitlement.

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The briefing says use the right protection | Request task-specific, approved safety information and confirm understanding without inventing a work method.

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A progress email overstates the inspection result | Report inspection findings and outstanding conditions without expanding a limited status into full approval.

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A handover needs item-level evidence | Transfer a closeout list with accurate status, ownership, and records rather than a misleading completion percentage.

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The delay is recorded; entitlement is not established | Describe a delay and supporting records without presenting an unreviewed claim as a proven right.

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Make the project meaning explicit

Construction language connects drawings, physical work, money, time, and responsibility. A small change from requested to approved can change what a colleague believes they may do. These cases practice the distinctions that keep a conversation tied to its evidence.

Replace adjectives with requirements

Flexible and high quality can conceal different expectations. Identify the users, activities, quantities, constraints, and performance the client actually needs before treating a preference as a settled design.

"Do you need two seating arrangements, or simultaneous activities in separate areas?"

Identify the document and its status

A sheet number alone may not identify the information used on site. Give its revision, the affected location, and the conflicting requirement; request clarification without assuming one document always takes precedence.

"Drawing A601 revision C and specification S09 revision B disagree at Room 205."

Separate proposals from instructions

A request for pricing, an estimated effect, an agreed change, and permission to proceed are different things. Use the project contract and authority arrangements, not an informal expression of enthusiasm, to establish status.

"The partition is priced as a proposal; no instruction to proceed has been issued."

Make evidence transferable

An incoming colleague needs more than a percentage or a green status. Connect the item, location, action, responsible person, and supporting record so that the next review can continue without reconstructing the conversation.

"Items 1 to 3 are verified closed; the other five still need review."

PROFESSIONAL BOUNDARIES

All projects, figures, people, and local processes are fictional. This book teaches workplace English, not design, legal, construction, code-compliance, or safety practice. Actual contracts, adopted codes, qualified professionals, and site procedures govern the work. No exercise authorizes construction or occupancy.

What does a flexible meeting room need to do?

A Read the situation

Turn broad client language into specific functional requirements without claiming design approval.

Client representative Amira asks architect Ben for a flexible meeting room. During briefing, she specifies workshops for 12 people at movable tables and presentations for 24 people in rows, at different times. Staff should be able to change the arrangement within 15 minutes. Remote participants must hear questions from anywhere in the room. These are requested performance targets, not verified design capabilities or approved occupant loads. Ben will prepare two layouts and seek audiovisual and code reviews. The room dimensions, storage provision, access requirements, and budget effects have not yet been assessed.

PEOPLE / Amira: Client representative | Ben: Architect

CLARIFICATION IS PART OF PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

A client may expect the designer to infer a complete solution from a familiar adjective. Ask about observable uses before recommending a form. Restating the client request accurately shows attention while leaving feasibility and regulatory review to the appropriate process.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. Which use pattern does Amira request?

- A Twenty-four people at workshop tables
- C Two arrangements used at different times

- B A permanently fixed boardroom arrangement
- D Two groups using the room simultaneously

2. What does the 15-minute figure describe?

- A A verified evacuation time
- C A regulatory approval period

- B A guaranteed design capability
- D A requested furniture-change target

3. Which statement about capacity is supported?

- A All layouts with twenty-four chairs are compliant.
- C The requested numbers still need design and code review.

- B The client can waive access requirements.
- D The room is approved for twenty-four occupants.

Answers and explanations: [page 85](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

design intent

The purpose and performance an intended design should achieve.

IN USE explain the design intent

client brief

A statement of the client's needs, priorities, and constraints.

IN USE develop the client brief

functional requirement

A description of what a space or system must enable.

IN USE define a functional requirement

space planning

Organizing space for activities, movement, and equipment.

IN USE review the space planning

occupant load

The number of occupants determined under applicable code provisions.

IN USE verify the occupant load

seating arrangement

The planned position and relationship of seats.

IN USE compare seating arrangements

theater-style seating

Rows of seats generally facing a presentation area.

IN USE propose theater-style seating

workshop layout

An arrangement supporting collaborative or practical group work.

IN USE develop a workshop layout

reconfigurable furniture

Furniture that can be rearranged for different uses.

IN USE specify reconfigurable furniture

changeover time

The time needed to change between arrangements or uses.

IN USE set a changeover target

circulation

Routes and space for movement within a building.

IN USE maintain clear circulation

egress

Movement out of a building or space, particularly for emergency exit.

IN USE review egress requirements

Precision check

Requested capacity is not approved occupant load. A layout drawing must still be assessed against the actual space and applicable requirements. Keep the client wish, proposed solution, and verified result distinct.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

accessibility

Usability of spaces and facilities by people with differing abilities.

IN USE integrate accessibility requirements

sightline

A line of vision from a viewing position to an object or area.

IN USE check presentation sightlines

acoustic performance

How a space handles sound for its intended use.

IN USE assess acoustic performance

reverberation

Persistence of sound after the original source stops.

IN USE evaluate reverberation

speech intelligibility

How clearly spoken words can be understood.

IN USE improve speech intelligibility

audiovisual (AV) system

Equipment for presenting or transmitting sound and images.

IN USE coordinate the AV system

microphone coverage

The area from which a microphone system can capture usable sound.

IN USE assess microphone coverage

power provision

The planned availability and location of electrical power.

IN USE coordinate power provision

storage allowance

Space reserved for items that are not currently in use.

IN USE include a storage allowance

adjacency

The relationship between nearby spaces or functions.

IN USE test an adjacency requirement

performance target

A desired measurable result that must still be evaluated.

IN USE state a performance target

design constraint

A condition limiting the available design choices.

IN USE identify a design constraint

Precision check

A room may support two arrangements without supporting both simultaneously. Name the use pattern and changeover target. For remote participation, sound quality needs its own requirement rather than an assumption that a screen solves the problem.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

CLARIFY A BROAD ADJECTIVE

"When you say flexible, which activities do you need?"

QUANTIFY WORKSHOP NEEDS

"The workshop arrangement needs twelve places at movable tables."

STATE THE CHANGEOVER TARGET

"Staff should be able to change layouts within fifteen minutes."

ASK ABOUT STORAGE

"Where will unused furniture be stored?"

SEPARATE USE PATTERNS

"Will those activities happen at the same time?"

QUANTIFY PRESENTATION NEEDS

"The presentation arrangement needs twenty-four seats in rows."

QUALIFY THE TARGET

"That is a requested target, not a tested capability."

SPECIFY THE LISTENING NEED

"Remote participants need to hear questions throughout the room."

Needs versus has

A required capability is not an existing verified capability.

At different times

Excludes simultaneous use from the supplied requirement.

Within

Gives a maximum target duration, not an approximate starting time.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

SEPARATE AV FUNCTIONS

"Displaying slides does not by itself provide microphone coverage."

NAME THE REVIEW BOUNDARY

"The layouts still need access and code review."

PRESERVE A CONSTRAINT

"We have not yet assessed the budget effect."

CONFIRM THE BRIEF

"The two activities occur at different times."

CHECK SIGHTLINES

"We need to assess views from the proposed seating positions."

AVOID A CAPACITY PROMISE

"I cannot confirm the approved occupant load from this brief."

OFFER A DEFINED NEXT STEP

"I will prepare two layouts for review."

CLOSE THE MEETING

"I will record these as requirements to be tested."

Can versus should

Can may claim ability; should here expresses a requested target.

Throughout

Extends the listening requirement beyond the presenter position.

For review

Keeps a proposed layout distinct from an approved design.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which brief statement is most precise?

- A** Two simultaneous twenty-four-person workshops
- B** Twelve-person workshops and twenty-four-person presentations at different times
- C** A flexible space for everybody
- D** A room guaranteed to meet every code

2. Which claim goes beyond the facts?

- A** The room is already approved for twenty-four occupants.
- B** Two layouts will be prepared.
- C** AV review is needed.
- D** Storage provision remains unassessed.

3. Which question clarifies the changeover requirement?

- A** How many remote participants normally join?
- B** Which presentation format is used most often?
- C** Who moves the furniture, and where does unused furniture go?
- D** Which wall finish does the client prefer?

4. Which response addresses remote participants?

- A** Assess sound capture from the room, not just the display.
- B** Add a screen and assume all questions are audible.
- C** Remove the requirement without asking.
- D** Treat remote listening as an occupant-load calculation.

[Answers and explanations: page 85.](#)

What does a flexible meeting room need to do?

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

client brief / occupant load / design constraints / sightlines / seating arrangements / speech intelligibility / microphone coverage / functional requirements / changeover time / circulation

- 01 **Amira:** We need a flexible meeting room. At the moment, every session feels squeezed into the same arrangement, even when the activity changes completely.
- 02 **Ben:** Let's make the ¹ _____ more specific. Are you describing different arrangements at different times, or two groups using separate parts of the room simultaneously?
- 03 **Amira:** Different times. We run workshops for twelve people at movable tables, then presentations for twenty-four people in rows. We do not need both together.
- 04 **Ben:** That gives us two distinct ² _____. I will draw both, but those numbers remain requested capacities until the layouts and relevant requirements have been reviewed.
- 05 **Amira:** Good. Staff also need to switch between them quickly. I would like the room ready for the next session within fifteen minutes, without specialist assistance.
- 06 **Ben:** I will record that ³ _____ as a performance target. We still need to assess the furniture, available storage, and who will actually make the change.
- 07 **Amira:** Could we simply leave the spare tables against the wall? That seems easier than creating a separate storage area somewhere else in the building.
- 08 **Ben:** We need to check the ⁴ _____ and access implications before choosing that solution. Unused furniture still occupies space, and the room dimensions have not yet been assessed.
- 09 **Amira:** Understood. The presentation layout must also work for people joining remotely. They often hear the presenter but miss questions from people sitting further back.
- 10 **Ben:** That is a ⁵ _____ requirement, not just a request for a larger screen. I will ask the AV specialist to assess sound capture across the room.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 10.

- 11 **Amira:** That is our current problem: a good screen, but remote colleagues cannot hear questions from the back. Please include those seats in the audio review.
- 12 **Ben:** We should also consider ⁶ _____. Capturing sound does not guarantee that words are clear. The room's acoustic behavior will need professional assessment alongside the equipment.
- 13 **Amira:** Can I tell our team the new room will hold twenty-four people? They want to start scheduling larger presentations as soon as the design begins.
- 14 **Ben:** Say that twenty-four is the requested presentation capacity. I cannot confirm the ⁷ _____ from this brief or authorize use before the required reviews.
- 15 **Amira:** I will tell the team the numbers are still being tested. Please also check whether people at the sides can see the diagrams.
- 16 **Ben:** I will include ⁸ _____ in the layout review. That requirement may affect furniture placement and display location, so we should not fix either independently too early.
- 17 **Amira:** What will you bring back to our next meeting? I need something concrete enough for staff to discuss without assuming the design is already settled.
- 18 **Ben:** Two proposed layouts and an explicit list of ⁹ _____. I will identify the outstanding dimensional, storage, access, AV, code, and budget reviews beside the requested performance.
- 19 **Amira:** That works. Please preserve the twelve and twenty-four figures, different-time use, and fifteen-minute target, while clearly showing that feasibility remains to be established.
- 20 **Ben:** Agreed. Those will form the recorded ¹⁰ _____. The next step is to test them against the actual room and project constraints, not to label them approved capabilities.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 86

1. client brief | 2. seating arrangements | 3. changeover time | 4. circulation | 5. microphone coverage | 6. speech intelligibility | 7. occupant load | 8. sightlines | 9. design constraints | 10. functional requirements

A second room brief

F Say it

A separate client requests workshops for 10 people and presentations for 18, at different times. The desired changeover is 20 minutes. None of the capacities is approved.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

18 / 10 / 20 / requested

Client: "The workshop needs ¹ _____ places."

Architect: "The presentation request is ² _____ seats."

Client: "The target changeover is ³ _____ minutes."

Architect: "Those capacities remain ⁴ _____, not approved."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 86

1. 10 | 2. 18 | 3. 20 | 4. requested

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read the corrected conversation, distinguishing 12 workshop places from 24 presentation seats.
2. Switch roles and repeat turns 5-12; emphasize the 15-minute target, storage, and hearing questions from the whole room.
3. Read the checked transfer twice using 10, 18, and 20. Keep requested capacity distinct from approved occupancy.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Two documents disagree about the same finish

A Read the situation

Describe a document discrepancy and request a traceable decision without inventing precedence.

Site coordinator Lena finds a finish discrepancy in Room 205. Drawing A601 revision C identifies wall finish F2; specification S09 revision B identifies F3 for the same wall. Both are in the current project issue. Neither document resolves the conflict, and no rule of precedence has been established in the supplied case. Architect Marco will coordinate a formal response. A project hold applies to the affected finish procurement until the discrepancy is resolved through the authorized process. The requested response date is Tuesday at 14:00, not a promised answer or automatic release.

PEOPLE / Lena: Site coordinator | Marco: Architect

CHALLENGE THE DOCUMENTS, NOT THE PERSON

A precise discrepancy report can be direct without accusing the designer of carelessness. Give the location and both references, then state the decision needed. Avoid turning a question into an instruction by writing a preferred answer as though it were already approved.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. Where is the discrepancy?

- A** Every floor in the building
- B** An unspecified external elevation
- C** A room that has already been closed out
- D** The same wall in Room 205

2. Which finish can Lena select from the supplied facts?

- A** Whichever can be delivered first
- B** Neither; an authorized clarification is required.
- C** F2 because drawings always win
- D** F3 because specifications always win

3. What does Tuesday at 14:00 mean?

- A** The requested response time
- B** Automatic procurement release
- C** A guaranteed architect response
- D** The finish installation completion time

Answers and explanations: page 87.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

request for information (RFI)

A documented request to clarify missing or conflicting project information.

IN USE raise an RFI

drawing reference

The identifier used to locate a drawing or detail.

IN USE cite the drawing reference

specification

Written requirements describing materials, quality, or execution.

IN USE review the specification

revision

A controlled version of a document after changes.

IN USE verify the revision

issue status

The purpose or authorization status assigned to a document release.

IN USE check the issue status

finish schedule

A listing of finishes assigned to spaces or surfaces.

IN USE consult the finish schedule

detail

An enlarged or specific representation of part of a design.

IN USE reference the detail

elevation

A drawing showing a vertical face of a building or element.

IN USE compare the elevation

section

A drawing showing a cut through a building or element.

IN USE review the section

callout

A notation directing the reader to a detail or requirement.

IN USE follow the callout

discrepancy

A difference between information that should agree.

IN USE document the discrepancy

document precedence

The applicable order of authority when project documents conflict.

IN USE establish document precedence

Precision check

Revision letters apply within their own document histories. Revision C of one drawing is not automatically more authoritative than revision B of a different specification. Establish the applicable documents and the authorized resolution.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

clarification

Information that resolves uncertainty about an existing requirement.

IN USE obtain written clarification

design coordination

Aligning design information across documents and disciplines.

IN USE coordinate the design response

submittal

Information submitted for the review required by the project process.

IN USE track the submittal

shop drawing

A detailed drawing prepared for fabrication or installation.

IN USE review the shop drawing

material sample

A physical example submitted to demonstrate a proposed material or finish.

IN USE submit a material sample

substitution

A proposed alternative to the specified product or arrangement.

IN USE request a substitution

procurement hold

A restriction on purchasing affected items pending a required decision.

IN USE maintain the procurement hold

response date

The stated date requested or committed for a reply.

IN USE distinguish the response date

RFI log

A register tracking information requests and their status.

IN USE update the RFI log

superseded document

A document replaced by a later applicable issue.

IN USE identify a superseded document

controlled distribution

A process for providing the correct document versions to recipients.

IN USE maintain controlled distribution

traceability

The ability to follow a decision back to its source and record.

IN USE preserve decision traceability

Precision check

An RFI response is not automatically permission for added cost or time. If the answer changes the work, route its consequences through the applicable contract process. Do not silently convert clarification into a change authorization.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

LOCATE THE ISSUE

"The discrepancy concerns the same wall in Room 205."

CITE THE SPECIFICATION

"S09 revision B identifies finish F3."

AVOID INVENTED PRECEDENCE

"The supplied information does not establish which requirement governs."

ATTACH SUPPORTING MATERIAL

"I will attach the marked location and both references."

CITE THE DRAWING

"A601 revision C identifies finish F2."

CONFIRM DOCUMENT STATUS

"Both references are in the current project issue."

ASK A BOUNDED QUESTION

"Please confirm the required finish for this wall."

SEPARATE A PROPOSAL

"Our suggested option is not an approved instruction."

Identifies

Reports what a document says without endorsing it as controlling.

For the same wall

Establishes that the references genuinely conflict.

Please confirm

Requests a specific decision, not general design advice.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

STATE THE CURRENT HOLD

"Affected finish procurement remains on hold."

AVOID AN IMPLIED GUARANTEE

"That date is requested, not confirmed."

CHECK CHANGE CONSEQUENCES

"Any cost or time effect needs the applicable change process."

KEEP UNAFFECTED WORK DISTINCT

"This hold applies to the affected finish procurement."

EXPLAIN THE REQUESTED DATE

"We request a response by Tuesday at 14:00."

TRACK THE REPLY

"We will record the formal response in the RFI log."

DISTRIBUTE THE DECISION

"Please identify the documents that need updating."

CLOSE WITH TRACEABILITY

"Link the decision to the RFI and the corrected document issue."

Requested by

Does not mean promised by the receiving person.

Suggested

Marks an option as a proposal rather than authority.

Current versus controlling

A current document may still conflict with another current document.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which RFI description is strongest?

- A** Please approve all finishes everywhere.
- B** Room 205 wall: A601 rev C says F2; S09 rev B says F3. Please confirm the required finish.
- C** The drawings are bad; sort them out.
- D** We chose F2 because C is later than B.

2. What follows from both references being current?

- A** The conflict still requires clarification.
- B** Both finishes must be installed together.
- C** Procurement is automatically released.
- D** One reference can be deleted without review.

3. What should happen if the reply adds cost or time?

- A** Use the applicable change-authorization process.
- B** Assume the RFI alone approves every consequence.
- C** Hide the effect in the next invoice.
- D** Treat the requested reply date as budget approval.

4. Which update is supported before a reply arrives?

- A** RFI open; affected finish procurement on hold; response requested Tuesday at 14:00.
- B** Finish approved; answer expected sometime.
- C** All site work stopped permanently.
- D** F3 approved because the specification uses words.

Answers and explanations: [page 87](#).

Two documents disagree about the same finish

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

document precedence / controlled distribution / RFI log / response date / procurement hold / document references / traceability / clarification / substitution / change authorization

- 01 **Lena:** I have a finish discrepancy in Room 205. The drawing and specification identify different finishes for the same wall, and procurement needs a definite answer.
- 02 **Marco:** Give me both ¹ _____ and their revisions. I want to check the current issue before anyone assumes an old print is the cause of the difference.
- 03 **Lena:** Drawing A601 revision C says F2. Specification S09 revision B says F3. Both appear in the current project issue, and neither explains the difference.
- 04 **Marco:** Then we need documented ² _____. Do not treat the letter C as automatically overriding B, because those revisions belong to different documents with separate histories.
- 05 **Lena:** A colleague suggested that specifications always take precedence over drawings. I have not found an applicable rule in the material available for this case.
- 06 **Marco:** We should not invent ³ _____. Raise the discrepancy through the project process and identify the decision needed. I will coordinate the formal architectural response.
- 07 **Lena:** I will mark the wall on the drawing and attach the specification extract. Should I include the finish we would prefer because it is available sooner?
- 08 **Marco:** You can label that as a proposal, but not as an approved ⁴ _____. The immediate question is which finish the design requires. Availability does not resolve the document conflict.
- 09 **Lena:** Understood. The affected finish procurement is currently on hold. I need the response by Tuesday at two in the afternoon to support the purchasing plan.
- 10 **Marco:** Record that as the requested ⁵ _____. I have not committed to that time. If coordination takes longer, we must communicate the status rather than silently release the purchase.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 19.

- 11 **Lena:** I will make the subject specific: Room 205 wall finish discrepancy. The question will ask you to confirm the required finish, with both references attached.
- 12 **Marco:** That will make the ⁶ _____ useful to the next person. Include the affected procurement item and current hold, without implying that every activity on site has stopped.
- 13 **Lena:** If your reply changes the finish, can the purchasing team immediately treat any extra cost as approved? They want one message that settles everything.
- 14 **Marco:** No. We must distinguish the design answer from the required ⁷ _____. Any effect on cost or time needs the applicable contract process, even if the technical answer is clear.
- 15 **Lena:** Then I will track the design reply and any commercial approval separately. Who needs the corrected information once the response is issued?
- 16 **Marco:** Use the project's ⁸ _____ process. Identify what needs updating, communicate the revised issue to affected recipients, and retain a traceable link to the original question and response.
- 17 **Lena:** Please tell us which sheets or extracts the response replaces. The buyer has a saved copy, and I do not want the old finish ordered after clarification.
- 18 **Marco:** Exactly. The goal is ⁹ _____, not simply an email saying resolved. A later reviewer should be able to find the question, authorized response, and resulting document changes.
- 19 **Lena:** For now, the RFI stays open and the affected procurement stays on hold. Tuesday at fourteen hundred is our requested response time, not a release deadline.
- 20 **Marco:** Correct. Maintain the ¹⁰ _____ until the authorized process resolves the issue. I will coordinate the response and make any remaining uncertainty or separate change requirement explicit.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 88

1. document references | 2. clarification | 3. document precedence | 4. substitution | 5. response date | 6. RFI log | 7. change authorization | 8. controlled distribution | 9. traceability | 10. procurement hold

Locate a different discrepancy

F Say it

Room 310 has a ceiling conflict: drawing A702 revision D says C1; specification S12 revision B says C4. Neither requirement has been confirmed.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

C4 / C1 / unconfirmed / 310

Coordinator: "The affected room is ¹ _____."

Architect: "The drawing identifies ceiling finish ² _____."

Coordinator: "The specification identifies ³ _____."

Architect: "The required finish remains ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 88

1. 310 | 2. C1 | 3. C4 | 4. unconfirmed

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read the corrected dialogue, stating each document identifier, revision, and finish separately.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20; distinguish the RFI response from cost authorization and the requested date from a promise.
3. Read the checked Room 310 transfer twice, keeping C1 and C4 attached to the correct source.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

A price request became an instruction in the minutes

A Read the situation

Distinguish pricing, approval, and authorization while explaining a proposed change in cost and time.

A client asks the project team to price an additional partition. The original contract sum is \$100,000; previously approved changes total a net addition of \$5,000. Estimator Noor proposes a further \$6,200 and an estimated two working days for the partition, subject to review. Neither has been accepted. No instruction to proceed has been issued under this fictional project's authorization process. Manager Felix notices that draft minutes say the client approved the work. The client actually requested pricing only. Other contracts may provide different change mechanisms; this case supplies no alternative instruction.

PEOPLE / Noor: Estimator | Felix: Project manager

ENTHUSIASM IS NOT A COMMERCIAL DECISION

A client saying that an idea looks useful may encourage a team to move quickly. Record the actual request and authority separately from the positive reaction. Accurate minutes protect shared understanding without requiring an accusatory conversation about who misunderstood whom.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What is the current approved contract sum?

- A \$100,000
- C \$106,200

- B \$111,200
- D \$105,000

2. What has the client authorized in this case?

- A Preparation of pricing only
- C A \$6,200 increase in the contract sum

- B Immediate partition construction
- D A two-day extension of contract time

3. What is the status of the two working days?

- A Two calendar weeks
- C An estimated effect subject to review

- B A completed delay analysis
- D An approved extension

Answers and explanations: [page 89](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

change order

A formal agreed change under the applicable contract process.

IN USE execute a change order

scope change

An alteration to the work or deliverables required.

IN USE assess a scope change

proposal request

A request to submit a price or other terms for proposed work.

IN USE issue a proposal request

contract sum

The monetary amount established by the construction contract and agreed adjustments.

IN USE state the current contract sum

approved adjustment

A change accepted through the applicable approval process.

IN USE record an approved adjustment

net addition

The overall increase after relevant additions and deductions.

IN USE calculate the net addition

deductive change

A change that reduces the relevant price or scope.

IN USE price a deductive change

proposed amount

A figure submitted for consideration rather than accepted.

IN USE separate the proposed amount

cost breakdown

An itemized explanation of the elements of a price.

IN USE request a cost breakdown

quantity takeoff

Measurement of material or work quantities for estimating.

IN USE check the quantity takeoff

labor allowance

An estimated amount assigned to labor in a price.

IN USE review the labor allowance

material cost

The cost assigned to materials for the work.

IN USE verify material costs

Precision check

The approved sum is \$105,000. Adding the unaccepted \$6,200 would produce \$111,200 only as a hypothetical revised sum. Show the pending proposal separately so the reader can distinguish agreed value from possible exposure.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

markup

An amount added to an underlying cost according to the pricing basis.

IN USE explain the markup

contingency

An allowance for identified uncertainty or potential future cost.

IN USE distinguish the contingency

exclusion

An item explicitly not included in a price or scope.

IN USE identify a pricing exclusion

pricing assumption

A condition used as the basis of an estimate.

IN USE state a pricing assumption

quotation validity

The period during which a quoted offer remains available on its stated terms.

IN USE check quotation validity

time impact

The effect of a change or event on the project schedule.

IN USE assess the time impact

working day

A day counted as working under the applicable project calendar.

IN USE specify working days

authorization to proceed

Permission to begin specified work under the applicable process.

IN USE verify authorization to proceed

change register

A record tracking proposed and approved changes.

IN USE maintain the change register

pending exposure

A potential cost or obligation that has not been settled.

IN USE report pending exposure

commitment

An obligation or undertaking, such as an approved purchase.

IN USE distinguish a cost commitment

construction change directive

A contract mechanism directing a change under specified conditions before all terms are agreed.

IN USE check a construction change directive

Precision check

This fictional project has no instruction to proceed. Do not turn that fact into a universal rule that every contract requires an agreed change order before any changed work. Different contractual mechanisms require their own authority and documentation.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

03

CORRECT THE MINUTES

"The client requested pricing, not construction."

SEPARATE THE PROPOSAL

"The additional six thousand two hundred dollars remains proposed."

QUALIFY THE DURATION

"The two working days are an estimate subject to review."

ASK FOR THE BASIS

"Please show the quantities and pricing assumptions."

STATE THE APPROVED VALUE

"The current approved contract sum is one hundred five thousand dollars."

EXPLAIN THE CONDITIONAL TOTAL

"If accepted, that proposal would bring the sum to one hundred eleven thousand two hundred dollars."

KEEP TIME SEPARATE

"No extension of contract time has been agreed."

CHECK WHAT IS MISSING

"Which items are excluded from this quotation?"

Would bring

Expresses a conditional total, not the present approved sum.

Net addition

Includes the effect of relevant deductions rather than adding every gross figure.

Subject to review

Preserves an unresolved assessment or decision.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

03

CLARIFY MARKUP

"Please distinguish direct cost from the proposed markup."

NAME THE CURRENT BOUNDARY

"No instruction to proceed has been issued in this case."

PRESERVE THE ORIGINAL DECISION

"The previously approved changes remain separate."

ROUTE THE DECISION

"Submit the proposal through the project's authorized process."

AVOID IMPLIED AUTHORIZATION

"Pricing the partition does not authorize construction."

TRACK THE STATUS

"Record the proposal as pending in the change register."

ADDRESS THE DEADLINE

"Check quotation validity before relying on this price later."

CLOSE THE CORRECTION

"I will circulate corrected minutes identifying the request accurately."

Working days

Requires a calendar basis; it is not automatically elapsed calendar days.

Requested pricing

Specifies the action asked for without expanding it to execution.

No instruction issued

Describes the supplied case, not every possible contract mechanism.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which cost summary is correct?

- A** Approved \$100,000; ignore prior changes
- B** Approved \$6,200; the original work is canceled
- C** Approved \$105,000; proposed addition \$6,200; hypothetical total \$111,200
- D** Approved \$111,200; proposal already included

2. Which minutes correction is appropriate?

- A** Record the estimate as an instruction from the client.
- B** Replace approved the partition with requested pricing for the partition.
- C** Delete the meeting because the price is uncertain.
- D** Mark the work complete because the client liked it.

3. What does an estimated two-day effect establish?

- A** A provisional schedule assessment
- B** An agreed contract extension
- C** Permission to miss every milestone
- D** A guarantee that no other task is affected

4. Which statement respects different contracts?

- A** Check the applicable mechanism and actual instruction; none is issued here.
- B** Every changed task always requires the same form first.
- C** A price estimate overrides every contract.
- D** Verbal enthusiasm always commits the owner to the quoted sum.

Answers and explanations: [page 89](#).

A price request became an instruction in the minutes

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

contract sum / commitment / net addition / change register / authorization to proceed / time impact / proposal request / cost breakdown / pricing assumptions / quotation validity

- 01 **Felix:** The draft minutes say the client approved the additional partition. I remember a request for pricing, not an instruction to build it. Does your record agree?
- 02 **Noor:** Yes. We received a ¹ _____. I prepared a price and provisional time estimate, but neither has been accepted through the project process.
- 03 **Felix:** Let's correct the minutes before the purchasing team relies on them. What is our current approved value, including the changes that were agreed earlier?
- 04 **Noor:** The original hundred thousand plus the approved five-thousand-dollar ² _____ gives us a hundred five thousand. The new partition proposal is separate.
- 05 **Felix:** And the six thousand two hundred for the partition would take that to a hundred eleven thousand two hundred only if it were accepted?
- 06 **Noor:** Correct. That is a conditional total, not the current ³ _____. I will show the approved value, pending proposal, and hypothetical revised figure on separate lines.
- 07 **Felix:** Before I send the proposal, show me what the six thousand two hundred includes. Are labor, materials, and markup separated?
- 08 **Noor:** I will attach the ⁴ _____, with quantities, labor and material allowances, markup, assumptions, and exclusions. The total alone does not explain the scope included in the offer.
- 09 **Felix:** The schedule note says two days. That could sound like we have already agreed an extension, especially if someone copies it without the qualification.
- 10 **Noor:** I will say estimated ⁵ _____ of two working days, subject to review. We have not agreed any extension of contract time or confirmed how the work fits the sequence.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

03

Continue with the word bank on page 28.

- 11 **Felix:** Please preserve working days as well. The client may read an unqualified two days as elapsed calendar time, which could produce a different expectation.
- 12 **Noor:** Agreed. I will also state the ⁶ _____. If the scope or planned execution changes, we need to review whether the quotation still represents the work being requested.
- 13 **Felix:** Can procurement reserve materials now? They want to keep the option available, but a reservation might create an obligation even before installation begins.
- 14 **Noor:** We need to check the proposed ⁷ _____ against the authorization process. In this case, no instruction to proceed has been issued, and I cannot authorize a purchase.
- 15 **Felix:** I will tell procurement that we have a pricing request, not an instruction to proceed. Flag any reservation charge before anyone commits us to it.
- 16 **Noor:** Exactly. The ⁸ _____ should show this item as pending. It should not be merged into the approved total simply because the client sounded enthusiastic.
- 17 **Felix:** We should also check how long the price remains available. The client may defer the decision and return later expecting every figure to remain unchanged.
- 18 **Noor:** I will confirm the ⁹ _____ and communicate it with the proposal. We should not invent a validity period or silently treat an expired offer as current.
- 19 **Felix:** I will circulate corrected minutes: pricing requested, six thousand two hundred proposed, two working days estimated, and no accepted cost or time adjustment.
- 20 **Noor:** Add that ¹⁰ _____ remains absent under this project's process. That gives the team a clear current status without turning the proposal into a decision.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 90

1. proposal request | 2. net addition | 3. contract sum | 4. cost breakdown | 5. time impact | 6. pricing assumptions | 7. commitment | 8. change register | 9. quotation validity | 10. authorization to proceed

Keep pending money separate

F Say it

Another contract started at \$80,000 and has approved net additions of \$4,000. A new \$3,000 proposal remains unaccepted. No time adjustment has been agreed.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

87,000 / 3,000 / 84,000 / unaccepted

Manager: "The current approved sum is \$¹ _____."

Estimator: "The pending proposal is \$² _____."

Manager: "If accepted, the revised sum would be \$³ _____."

Estimator: "The proposed change remains ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 90

1. 84,000 | 2. 3,000 | 3. 87,000 | 4. unaccepted

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read the corrected conversation with \$105,000 approved and \$6,200 proposed.
2. Switch roles; stress would in the \$111,200 total and estimated in the two-working-day effect.
3. Read the checked transfer twice. Keep \$84,000 current and \$87,000 conditional on acceptance.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

The lookahead still shows a delivery that cannot happen

04

A Read the situation

Explain a constrained sequence and distinguish forecast movement from contractual entitlement.

A simplified project calendar uses numbered working days. The baseline shows delivery at the end of Day 1, installation on Days 2 and 3, and testing on Day 4. Each task depends on the previous one finishing; no overlap or float is available in this supplied sequence. Delivery is now forecast at the end of Day 3. Installation still needs two full working days, followed by one testing day. Planner Imani and site manager Owen have not verified any recovery option. The lookahead still shows the original dates. This arithmetic is not a contract-extension decision.

PEOPLE / Imani: Planner | Owen: Site manager

A CHANGED FORECAST IS INFORMATION, NOT DISLOYALTY

A team may feel that moving a date admits defeat. Keeping an obsolete plan visible as the current forecast is more misleading. Preserve the baseline for comparison, show the supported forecast, and evaluate recovery options separately from promises.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. With the stated dependencies, when can installation occur?

- A Days 4 and 5
- C Day 3 only

- B Days 2 and 3
- D Before delivery is complete

2. When does testing move to?

- A Day 6
- C Day 3

- B Day 4
- D Day 5 while installation is unfinished

3. What has been established about recovery?

- A Overtime definitely restores Day 4.
- C The dependency can be ignored.

- B Testing can be omitted.
- D No recovery option has been verified.

Answers and explanations: page 91.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

baseline schedule

The agreed reference plan used for comparison with later progress.

IN USE retain the baseline schedule

lookahead schedule

A short-term plan of upcoming activities and requirements.

IN USE update the lookahead schedule

critical path

A sequence of activities determining the relevant earliest completion under the schedule logic.

IN USE review the critical path

predecessor

An activity that must occur before a linked activity under the schedule logic.

IN USE identify the predecessor

successor

An activity linked to follow another under the schedule logic.

IN USE identify the successor

finish-to-start relationship

A link requiring one activity to finish before the next starts.

IN USE model a finish-to-start relationship

activity duration

The time required to perform a scheduled activity.

IN USE verify the activity duration

total float

Time an activity can move without delaying the relevant project completion under the schedule model.

IN USE assess total float

free float

Time an activity can move without delaying the early start of a successor.

IN USE distinguish free float

lead time

The time needed to obtain an item or complete a preparatory process.

IN USE confirm the lead time

forecast date

The date currently expected on the basis of available information.

IN USE revise the forecast date

data date

The point in time to which schedule progress information is updated.

IN USE state the data date

Precision check

The delivery moves from the end of Day 1 to the end of Day 3. With unchanged durations and no overlap, installation moves to Days 4 and 5, and testing to Day 6. The forecast shifts two working days.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

milestone

A significant scheduled event, usually with no duration.

IN USE track the testing milestone

constraint

A restriction affecting when or how an activity may occur.

IN USE identify a schedule constraint

workfront

An area or package available for a crew to perform work.

IN USE release a workfront

sequence

The order in which activities are carried out.

IN USE preserve the required sequence

recovery plan

A proposal for regaining lost time or limiting delay.

IN USE evaluate a recovery plan

acceleration

Measures intended to complete work sooner than otherwise forecast.

IN USE assess acceleration options

resource availability

The availability of labor, equipment, or other required inputs.

IN USE verify resource availability

productivity

The output achieved per unit of input or time.

IN USE test productivity assumptions

schedule variance

A difference between planned and actual or forecast timing.

IN USE explain the schedule variance

critical-path analysis

Evaluation of schedule logic and the activities driving completion.

IN USE update the critical-path analysis

extension of time

A contractual adjustment to the allowed completion period when properly established.

IN USE distinguish an extension of time

calendar basis

The working and nonworking periods used to count schedule time.

IN USE state the calendar basis

Precision check

A schedule forecast describes expected timing under stated assumptions. It does not by itself establish responsibility for delay, entitlement to extra time, or entitlement to payment. Recovery proposals also require evidence, resources, and appropriate approval.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

IDENTIFY THE REFERENCE

"The baseline places testing on Day 4."

EXPLAIN THE DEPENDENCY

"Installation cannot start until delivery is complete."

CALCULATE THE NEW SEQUENCE

"Installation moves to Days 4 and 5."

QUANTIFY THE VARIANCE

"That is a two-working-day movement from the baseline."

STATE THE CHANGED INPUT

"Delivery is now forecast for the end of Day 3."

PRESERVE THE DURATION

"Installation still requires two full working days."

STATE THE RESULTING FORECAST

"Testing moves to Day 6 under the supplied logic."

KEEP THE REFERENCE INTACT

"Retain the baseline and show the revised forecast separately."

At the end of

Matters because the successor cannot use the same full working day.

Still requires

Keeps the activity duration unchanged despite pressure.

Moves to

Reports a forecast change without assigning legal responsibility.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

CORRECT THE SHORT-TERM PLAN

"The lookahead must reflect the current delivery forecast."

CHECK RESOURCES

"Extra hours are not a recovery plan until their feasibility is assessed."

QUALIFY THE MODEL

"This result follows the simplified sequence supplied here."

STATE THE CLOCK BASIS

"These are numbered working days, not calendar dates."

AVOID UNSUPPORTED RECOVERY

"We have not verified an option that restores Day 4."

PROTECT THE DEPENDENCY

"We cannot assume testing overlaps unfinished installation."

SEPARATE CONTRACTUAL QUESTIONS

"The forecast does not itself grant an extension of time."

CLOSE WITH THE NEXT UPDATE

"I will issue the revised lookahead with its assumptions."

No float

Removes unused schedule allowance in the supplied model.

Under the supplied logic

Limits the calculation to its stated assumptions.

Restore versus request

A proposed recovery action does not prove the old date can be restored.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which sequence follows the supplied facts?

- A** Delivery ends Day 3; installation Day 3; testing Day 4
- B** Delivery ends Day 3; skip testing
- C** Installation Days 2-3 despite the missing delivery
- D** Delivery ends Day 3; installation Days 4-5; testing Day 6

2. How should the schedule records be handled?

- A** Preserve the baseline and update the current lookahead.
- B** Delete the baseline to hide the movement.
- C** Keep the old forecast because it looks better.
- D** Change the delivery date but leave dependent tasks unchanged.

3. What is the variance in testing?

- A** No movement because the baseline is fixed
- B** Two working days later
- C** Two calendar weeks later
- D** One working day earlier

4. Which contractual conclusion is supported?

- A** The contractor must accelerate without review.
- B** None is established by this calculation alone.
- C** A two-day extension is automatically approved.
- D** The supplier owes every additional cost.

Answers and explanations: [page 91](#).

The lookahead still shows a delivery that cannot happen

E Conversations / turns 1-10

04

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

schedule variance / activity duration / lookahead schedule / recovery plan / extension of time / finish-to-start relationship / baseline schedule / forecast date / calendar basis / resource availability

- 01 **Owen:** The delivery update says the end of Day 3, but our lookahead still shows installation on Days 2 and 3. The crews are asking which plan applies.
- 02 **Imani:** The ¹ _____ needs correcting. We should keep the baseline for comparison, but it cannot remain our current forecast when a necessary input has moved.
- 03 **Owen:** Walk me through the sequence before I brief them. Delivery originally finished at the end of Day 1, installation took two days, and testing followed.
- 04 **Imani:** Correct. The ² _____ means installation cannot begin before delivery finishes. With delivery now ending on Day 3, installation uses Days 4 and 5.
- 05 **Owen:** So testing moves to Day 6, provided the installation duration stays at two full working days and there is no other change to the supplied sequence.
- 06 **Imani:** Exactly. The ³ _____ has not shortened. We have no overlap or float available in this model, so the delivery movement passes through to the testing date.
- 07 **Owen:** The installer has been asked to catch up and keep testing on Day 4. Has anyone checked a workable way to do that?
- 08 **Imani:** It is not a verified ⁴ _____. We would need to assess the proposed method, resources, productivity, and constraints before making a commitment based on a shorter duration.
- 09 **Owen:** Extra hours are being discussed. I do not know whether the crew, equipment, access arrangements, or necessary supervision would actually be available for them.
- 10 **Imani:** Then ⁵ _____ remains an open question. We should label acceleration as an option under review, not assume it restores the original testing date without consequences.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 37.

- 11 **Owen:** I also want to avoid confusion about days. This example uses numbered working days, not dates on a calendar with a weekend somewhere in the middle.
- 12 **Imani:** State the ⁶ _____ explicitly. Day 6 is two working days later than Day 4. We should not translate that into calendar dates without the project calendar.
- 13 **Owen:** Please keep the original Day 4 alongside the forecast. The client will want to see the movement, not just a replacement date.
- 14 **Imani:** Retain the ⁷ _____ and show the forecast beside it. That makes the two-day movement visible instead of hiding it by overwriting the original reference.
- 15 **Owen:** Then the client sees both the original testing point and the expected one. We can explain the dependency rather than present a date with no basis.
- 16 **Imani:** Yes. Describe the ⁸ _____ and its assumptions. If the delivery forecast changes again, or a recovery option becomes verified, update the analysis rather than reuse this result automatically.
- 17 **Owen:** Does this mean we can state that a two-day extension of time has been approved? The project report has a column asking about contractual completion.
- 18 **Imani:** No. An ⁹ _____ is a separate contractual question. This calculation establishes neither entitlement nor responsibility, and it does not approve payment or an adjusted contract completion date.
- 19 **Owen:** I will brief installation on Days 4 and 5 and testing on Day 6 under the supplied assumptions, with recovery still unverified and contractual questions separate.
- 20 **Imani:** I will issue that ¹⁰ _____ in the revised lookahead and retain the baseline comparison. The record will show the changed delivery input and the unchanged activity durations clearly.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 92

1. lookahead schedule | 2. finish-to-start relationship | 3. activity duration | 4. recovery plan | 5. resource availability | 6. calendar basis | 7. baseline schedule | 8. schedule variance | 9. extension of time | 10. forecast date

Follow the dependency chain

F Say it

Delivery finishes at the end of Day 5. Installation needs two full working days after delivery. Testing takes the following full day. No overlap is available.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

7 / 8 / overlap / 6

Planner: "Installation begins on Day ¹ _____."

Manager: "Its second day is Day ² _____."

Planner: "Testing therefore occurs on Day ³ _____."

Manager: "The dependency permits no ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 92

1. 6 | 2. 7 | 3. 8 | 4. overlap

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read the corrected dialogue with delivery ending Day 3, installation Days 4-5, and testing Day 6.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Retain working days and keep a forecast separate from a contractual extension.
3. Read the checked transfer twice using Days 6, 7, and 8 without overlapping the activities.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

The briefing says use the right protection

A Read the situation

Request task-specific, approved safety information and confirm understanding without inventing a work method.

A crew is due to cut composite panels with a powered tool in Zone B. The briefing card says only use the right protection. It does not identify the approved task method, controls, or equipment requirements. Foreperson Rosa has stopped the affected task under the fictional site process. Safety coordinator Dev will obtain qualified review and the applicable approved briefing before any authorized restart. No one is being asked to select equipment from this book. Similar work performed elsewhere does not establish that the same requirements apply here. The immediate need is a clear escalation and repeat-back.

PEOPLE / Rosa: Foreperson | Dev: Safety coordinator

REPEAT-BACK CHECKS THE MESSAGE, NOT INTELLIGENCE

Experienced workers can interpret the same vague phrase differently. Ask someone to restate the task status and next requirement as a check on the briefing itself. Do not ask for a yes merely to complete an attendance record.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What is missing from the card?

- | | |
|--|--|
| A The task-specific approved method, controls, and equipment requirements | B Only the spelling of Zone B |
| C Proof that everyone has done identical work | D Permission to ignore the site process |

2. What is the affected task's current status?

- | | |
|---|--|
| A Automatically safe because workers are experienced | B Stopped under the local process |
| C Authorized to begin immediately | D Completed and inspected |

3. What can experience on another site establish here?

- | | |
|---|--|
| A It replaces the approved briefing. | B It authorizes any worker to restart. |
| C It proves all panel products have identical hazards. | D It does not by itself establish the requirements for this task. |

Answers and explanations: [page 93](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

toolbox talk

A focused workplace briefing about a task or safety topic.

IN USE deliver a toolbox talk

task briefing

Instructions and relevant information for a specific planned activity.

IN USE clarify the task briefing

method statement

A document describing the planned method and relevant controls for work.

IN USE consult the approved method statement

job hazard analysis (JHA)

A structured review of task steps, hazards, and controls.

IN USE review the job hazard analysis

hazard identification

Recognition of conditions or activities that may cause harm.

IN USE complete hazard identification

risk assessment

Evaluation of risks and the controls needed to manage them.

IN USE review the risk assessment

hierarchy of controls

An ordered approach favoring more effective risk controls over reliance on individual behavior.

IN USE apply the hierarchy of controls

engineering control

A physical or technical measure that reduces exposure to a hazard.

IN USE verify engineering controls

administrative control

A work-practice or organizational measure intended to reduce risk.

IN USE communicate administrative controls

personal protective equipment (PPE)

Equipment worn to help protect a person from specified hazards.

IN USE specify task-appropriate PPE

exposure

Contact with or presence in conditions that may cause harm.

IN USE assess worker exposure

dust extraction

Equipment or arrangements used to capture dust near its source.

IN USE review dust extraction requirements

Precision check

The phrase right protection supplies no usable task requirement. Clarification must address the applicable method and controls, not simply invent a list of items to wear. PPE is not a replacement for the wider control process.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

noise assessment

Evaluation of noise conditions and potential exposure.

IN USE obtain a noise assessment

safety data sheet (SDS)

A document communicating information about a chemical product and its hazards.

IN USE consult the safety data sheet

equipment guarding

Protective arrangements restricting access to hazardous equipment parts.

IN USE verify equipment guarding

isolation

Separation from an energy source or hazard under the applicable process.

IN USE follow the isolation procedure

exclusion zone

An area with access restricted for a specified safety reason.

IN USE identify the exclusion zone

task competence

The knowledge and ability required to perform a particular task.

IN USE verify task competence

site induction

Initial orientation to the requirements of a particular site.

IN USE complete the site induction

repeat-back

Restating a message to confirm its accurate receipt and understanding.

IN USE request a repeat-back

stop-work instruction

A direction to halt a specified activity under the relevant process.

IN USE communicate a stop-work instruction

restart condition

A requirement that must be satisfied before work resumes.

IN USE state the restart conditions

briefing record

Documentation of the briefing and relevant participation or acknowledgement.

IN USE maintain the briefing record

near miss

An event that could have caused harm but did not produce the relevant loss.

IN USE report a near miss

Precision check

A signed attendance record does not demonstrate that each person understood the instruction. Use a repeat-back of the actual task status and next requirement. This dialogue does not supply a technical cutting method or authorize a restart.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

NAME THE AFFECTED ACTIVITY

"The panel-cutting task in Zone B is stopped."

IDENTIFY THE GAP

"The card does not specify the approved requirements."

ASK FOR THE APPLICABLE DOCUMENT

"Which approved method statement covers this task?"

REQUEST QUALIFIED REVIEW

"Please obtain the task-specific assessment and controls."

AVOID EQUIPMENT GUESSING

"I will not select protective equipment from a generic phrase."

BROADEN THE CONTROL QUESTION

"We need the full control arrangement, not PPE alone."

DISTINGUISH SIMILAR WORK

"Experience elsewhere does not confirm the requirements here."

STATE THE RESTART BOUNDARY

"The required clarification and authorization are still pending."

Right

Too vague unless the actual task requirement is identified.

Covers this task

Tests applicability, not merely the existence of a document.

Still pending

Keeps an unresolved condition visible during handover.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

CHECK THE MESSAGE

"Please repeat the task status and next requirement."

PRESERVE RESPONSIBILITY

"Dev will coordinate the qualified review."

RECORD THE CURRENT STATUS

"The briefing remains incomplete for this task."

MAKE THE NEXT BRIEFING SPECIFIC

"Identify the task, approved controls, and responsible supervisor."

CORRECT A MISUNDERSTANDING

"Attending the talk does not mean the task is released."

AVOID AN IMPLIED SHORTCUT

"Schedule pressure does not complete the missing assessment."

CONFIRM THE LOCATION

"This concern applies to the planned activity in Zone B."

CLOSE THE LOOP

"Communicate an authorized status change explicitly before resuming."

Repeat

Requests the message back, not a new safety plan from the learner.

Attendance versus understanding

A record of presence is not proof of comprehension.

Authorized status change

Prevents silence or movement on site from being mistaken for release.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which clarification is most useful?

- A** Which approved method and controls apply to cutting these panels in Zone B?
- B** Can everyone just be careful?
- C** Which equipment looks most protective?
- D** Can the crew copy an unrelated site's briefing?

2. Which statement about controls is accurate?

- A** A briefing card proves all hazards are eliminated.
- B** A worker's confidence establishes the exposure level.
- C** PPE requirements belong within the applicable wider control arrangement.
- D** Wearing any PPE replaces every other control.

3. Which repeat-back matches the facts?

- A** The card is complete because everyone signed it.
- B** No review is needed for experienced staff.
- C** The task is stopped; qualified clarification and restart authorization are pending.
- D** The task can restart because Dev received the message.

4. What should Rosa avoid?

- A** Asking who owns the review
- B** Reporting the current stopped status
- C** Inventing equipment requirements to complete the card
- D** Identifying the affected task

Answers and explanations: [page 93](#).

The briefing says use the right protection

E Conversations / turns 1-10

05

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

briefing record / risk assessment / repeat-back / method statement / stop-work instruction / toolbox talk / task briefing / hierarchy of controls / restart conditions / Personal protective equipment

- 01 **Rosa:** I have stopped the panel-cutting task in Zone B. The briefing card says use the right protection, but it does not identify what that means here.
- 02 **Dev:** That ¹ _____ is incomplete. I will obtain the qualified review and applicable approved information before we consider any authorized restart under the local process.
- 03 **Rosa:** The crew has cut panels before, and one worker says we should simply use the same arrangement as at the previous site. I cannot verify the match.
- 04 **Dev:** Previous experience does not establish this ² _____. Materials, equipment, and working conditions can differ. We need the requirements applicable to this task, not a remembered instruction from somewhere else.
- 05 **Rosa:** I will keep the affected task stopped. Should my clarification request ask only which protective equipment the workers need, or is that still too narrow?
- 06 **Dev:** Ask for the full approved method and controls. ³ _____ is not the entire control arrangement. We should not reduce the question to a list of items to wear.
- 07 **Rosa:** Then I will identify the composite panels, powered tool, location, and missing task-specific information, and ask which approved document covers the proposed work.
- 08 **Dev:** Yes. The applicable ⁴ _____ and assessment need qualified review. Do not infer technical requirements from this conversation or from an unrelated document with a similar title.
- 09 **Rosa:** Several people have already signed the attendance sheet. I need to tell them the task is still stopped; that signature has not resolved the missing requirements.
- 10 **Dev:** A ⁵ _____ cannot replace clear instructions. We need to check understanding of the current status, and later of the actual approved requirements, without treating a signature as technical approval.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 46.

05

- 11 **Rosa:** I can ask the crew to repeat the status and next step. That seems more useful than asking whether everybody understands and receiving a quick yes.
- 12 **Dev:** Use a ⁶ _____. Explain that you are checking the message, not testing anyone's intelligence. The required response now is that the task remains stopped pending clarification and authorization.
- 13 **Rosa:** Can I put you down as the review contact? I will tell the other supervisors who is obtaining the task-specific clarification.
- 14 **Dev:** That gives the ⁷ _____ a clear follow-up owner. My receiving the concern does not release the task; any change in its status must be communicated through the local process.
- 15 **Rosa:** The installation team is waiting for these panels. They will want an estimate, but we do not yet know how long obtaining the missing information will take.
- 16 **Dev:** We can report that uncertainty without weakening the ⁸ _____. Schedule pressure does not complete the assessment. I will provide an update when we have verified information, rather than invent a release time.
- 17 **Rosa:** The approved briefing should distinguish physical controls, working arrangements, and personal protection, so staff understand their different purposes.
- 18 **Dev:** The ⁹ _____ helps frame that distinction. Qualified personnel must establish the actual measures; this exchange is about obtaining and communicating those requirements accurately.
- 19 **Rosa:** My immediate message is clear: Zone B panel cutting is stopped, the generic instruction is insufficient, and you are coordinating the task-specific review.
- 20 **Dev:** Correct. The next ¹⁰ _____ needs that approved information and a check of understanding. We will not treat attendance, experience, or my acknowledgement as permission to resume.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 94

1. task briefing | 2. risk assessment | 3. Personal protective equipment | 4. method statement | 5. briefing record | 6. repeat-back | 7. stop-work instruction | 8. restart conditions | 9. hierarchy of controls | 10. toolbox talk

Repeat the current task status

F Say it

A separate lifting task in Zone D is stopped. The applicable approved briefing is missing. Coordinator Sana owns the review. No restart has been authorized.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

stopped / D / Sana / unauthorized

Foreperson: "The affected location is Zone ¹ _____."

Coordinator: "The task is currently ² _____."

Foreperson: "The named review owner is ³ _____."

Coordinator: "A restart remains ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 94

1. D | 2. stopped | 3. Sana | 4. unauthorized

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read turns 1-10 with the answers, naming Zone B and the incomplete task briefing.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20; repeat the current stopped status without inventing a cutting method or equipment list.
3. Read the checked Zone D transfer twice, retaining Sana as review owner and no authorized restart.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

A progress email overstates the inspection result

A Read the situation

Report inspection findings and outstanding conditions without expanding a limited status into full approval.

06

An inspection record for Area C lists four items. Items 1 and 2 are recorded closed by the relevant authority; Items 3 and 4 remain open. Contractor photographs have been submitted for the latter two, but no acceptance of those corrections is recorded. No occupancy permission has been issued for Area C in the supplied case. Coordinator Talia finds a progress email saying fully approved. Architect Marcus will help correct the statement and coordinate the outstanding evidence. The local jurisdiction and adopted code requirements must be checked by qualified personnel; no code interpretation is supplied here.

PEOPLE / Talia: Project coordinator | Marcus: Architect

APPROVAL NEEDS AN OBJECT AND AN AUTHORITY

Approved can refer to a product, a drawing, an inspection item, or permission to use a space. Ask what was approved, by whom, and in which record. This is not excessive formality when a broader interpretation could lead someone to act beyond the actual decision.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. How many inspection items are recorded closed?

A Two

B Four

C None

D Three

2. What do the photographs establish about Items 3 and 4?

A Occupancy permission is issued.

B The authority has waived every requirement.

C Evidence was submitted, but acceptance is not recorded.

D Both items are accepted as closed.

3. Which occupancy statement is supported?

A The architect's progress email grants occupancy.

B Half the inspection items allow half the area to be occupied.

C No permission is issued in the supplied case.

D Full use is automatically authorized.

Answers and explanations: page 95.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

authority having jurisdiction (AHJ)

The relevant authority responsible for interpreting or enforcing applicable requirements.

IN USE identify the authority having jurisdiction

adopted code

A code given effect by the relevant jurisdiction, including applicable amendments.

IN USE verify the adopted code

local amendment

A jurisdiction-specific change to a model code or requirement.

IN USE check local amendments

permit

An authorization issued under the applicable regulatory process for specified work or use.

IN USE verify the permit scope

plan review

Examination of proposed documents against relevant requirements.

IN USE respond to plan-review comments

inspection record

Documentation of an inspection and its findings or status.

IN USE consult the inspection record

inspection finding

A recorded observation or result from an inspection.

IN USE address an inspection finding

outstanding item

A matter that has not yet been resolved or accepted as complete.

IN USE track an outstanding item

correction notice

A notice identifying work or information that needs correction.

IN USE respond to a correction notice

resubmittal

Information submitted again after revision or additional work.

IN USE prepare a resubmittal

reinspection

A further inspection following earlier findings or changes.

IN USE request a reinspection

acceptance record

Documentation that the relevant reviewer has accepted a specified item.

IN USE obtain an acceptance record

Precision check

Two closed items out of four is 50% of this item count. It is not proof that the area is half compliant, half approved for use, or 50% complete by cost. Items differ in importance and regulatory effect.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

conditional approval

Approval that remains subject to stated conditions.

IN USE preserve conditional approval terms

approval scope

The specific work, area, or matter covered by an approval.

IN USE state the approval scope

occupancy permission

Authorization to use or occupy an area under the applicable jurisdictional process.

IN USE verify occupancy permission

certificate of occupancy (CO)

A jurisdictional document concerning authorized occupancy under its applicable requirements.

IN USE check the certificate of occupancy

temporary occupancy

Occupancy permitted for a limited scope or period under applicable conditions.

IN USE verify temporary occupancy conditions

code compliance

Conformity with the applicable adopted requirements.

IN USE demonstrate code compliance

supporting evidence

Material submitted to substantiate a response or claim.

IN USE attach supporting evidence

inspection status

The recorded position of the relevant inspection process or items.

IN USE report inspection status

permit closeout

Completion of the applicable steps for closing a permit record.

IN USE coordinate permit closeout

design professional

A suitably qualified professional responsible for relevant design services.

IN USE consult the design professional

jurisdiction

The authority or geographic area governing applicable rules.

IN USE identify the jurisdiction

public-use restriction

A limitation on use by occupants or the public under applicable requirements.

IN USE communicate a public-use restriction

Precision check

Photographs are supporting evidence, not the reviewer decision. Keep submitted, accepted, closed, and permitted for occupancy separate. Contractual completion language also does not replace the relevant jurisdictional permission to use an area.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

CORRECT THE BROAD CLAIM

"Fully approved is not supported by this inspection record."

PRESERVE THE OPEN ITEMS

"Items 3 and 4 remain open."

AVOID OVERSTATING SUBMISSION

"Acceptance of those corrections is not recorded."

LIMIT THE STATEMENT

"This update concerns the four listed inspection items."

REPORT THE CLOSED ITEMS

"Items 1 and 2 are recorded closed."

DESCRIBE THE EVIDENCE

"Photographs have been submitted for the two outstanding items."

NAME THE AUTHORITY

"Please identify the authority responsible for this decision."

SEPARATE OCCUPANCY

"No occupancy permission is issued in the supplied case."

06

Fully

Expands a claim to the whole relevant scope and needs corresponding evidence.

Submitted

Describes delivery of evidence, not acceptance.

Recorded closed

Connects the status to the authority's documented decision.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

ASK FOR THE RECORD

"Which document supports the approval claim?"

COORDINATE THE NEXT STEP

"Confirm the required evidence and any reinspection process."

KEEP CONDITIONS VISIBLE

"Any approval must be reported with its actual scope and conditions."

PRESERVE EVIDENCE LINKS

"Link each item to its submission and acceptance record."

CHECK LOCAL REQUIREMENTS

"The adopted code and local amendments need qualified review."

AVOID ASSUMED TIMING

"A request for review does not confirm an inspection appointment."

CORRECT ALL RECIPIENTS

"Send the revised status to everyone who received the original claim."

CLOSE ACCURATELY

"I will update the status only when the relevant decision is documented."

06

No permission issued

Does not imply that permission is impossible later.

For Area C

Limits the location and avoids claims about the whole project.

Subject to conditions

Conditions must remain visible, not disappear from a short summary.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which progress statement is accurate?

- A** Half the area may be occupied because half the items are closed.
- B** Two items closed; two open with photographs submitted; no occupancy permission issued.
- C** Area C fully approved because photographs were sent.
- D** All work rejected because two items remain open.

2. What can 2 out of 4 measure here?

- A** Fifty percent of legal occupancy permission
- B** Fifty percent of total construction value
- C** Fifty percent of every code requirement
- D** Fifty percent of the listed item count

3. Which evidence would support changing an item's status?

- A** The number of people copied on the email
- B** The relevant documented acceptance or closure decision
- C** A photograph sent but not reviewed
- D** A colleague's optimistic summary

4. Which question makes approved precise?

- A** When was the progress email sent to the client?
- B** How many photographs were attached to the submission?
- C** Who expects the remaining work to finish this week?
- D** What was approved, by whom, and in which record?

Answers and explanations: [page 95](#).

A progress email overstates the inspection result

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

06

WORD + PHRASE BANK

supporting evidence / occupancy permission / acceptance record / Code compliance / inspection status / conditional approval / authority having jurisdiction / approval scope / Permit closeout / reinspection

- 01 **Talia:** The progress email says Area C is fully approved. I am looking at four inspection items, and only the first two are recorded closed.
- 02 **Marcus:** Then the ¹ _____ is overstated. Please identify the record and send a correction to the original recipients before someone treats that sentence as permission to use the area.
- 03 **Talia:** Items 3 and 4 have contractor photographs attached. The team may have assumed that submitting those photographs meant the corrections were accepted by the reviewer.
- 04 **Marcus:** The photographs are ² _____, not an acceptance decision. We need to preserve submitted and accepted as different statuses until the relevant review is documented.
- 05 **Talia:** I will say Items 1 and 2 are closed, Items 3 and 4 remain open, and photographs have been submitted for review of the outstanding corrections.
- 06 **Marcus:** Add the ³ _____. We are reporting these four listed items, not claiming that every requirement for the area or the whole project has been satisfied.
- 07 **Talia:** The dashboard says fifty percent approved because two of four items are closed. Should the label say listed items closed instead?
- 08 **Marcus:** Call it fifty percent of the listed item count closed. ⁴ _____ cannot be reduced to that arithmetic, because the items may differ in significance and effect.
- 09 **Talia:** We also have no occupancy permission for Area C in this case. Should that be a separate line, rather than something readers have to infer from the open items?
- 10 **Marcus:** Yes. State ⁵ _____ not issued. Do not imply that closing half the items permits use of half the area, or that our architectural coordination supplies the missing authority.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 55.

- 11 **Talia:** The client asks whether a temporary arrangement might be possible. I can pass on the question, but cannot promise any exception or partial use.
- 12 **Marcus:** Correct. The ⁶ _____ and qualified project professionals must address that under actual local requirements. This record gives us no basis for offering permission or predicting the outcome.
- 13 **Talia:** I will ask whether the photographs are sufficient or another visit is required. At present, I have requested a follow-up but have no appointment.
- 14 **Marcus:** Keep a requested ⁷ _____ separate from a booked visit and a completed decision. Otherwise, the next update could repeat the same mistake using a different status word.
- 15 **Talia:** For each open item, I will link the photographs, date of submission, outstanding response, and responsible coordinator. That should make the next follow-up easier.
- 16 **Marcus:** Include the eventual ⁸ _____ when it exists. Do not mark the item closed just because its folder contains more documents than it did yesterday.
- 17 **Talia:** The client also has a contractual completion discussion next week. I want to avoid suggesting that such a project milestone automatically resolves the regulatory position.
- 18 **Marcus:** Keep those processes distinct. ⁹ _____ and occupancy requirements depend on the relevant jurisdiction. We should report their actual documented statuses alongside, not underneath, a broad completion label.
- 19 **Talia:** My correction will preserve all four item numbers, the two closures, the two pending reviews, and the absence of occupancy permission for the specified area.
- 20 **Marcus:** Good. Any later ¹⁰ _____ must retain its conditions in the summary. We will update the record when the relevant decision arrives, not when somebody hopes it will.

06

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 96

1. inspection status | 2. supporting evidence | 3. approval scope | 4. Code compliance | 5. occupancy permission | 6. authority having jurisdiction | 7. reinspection | 8. acceptance record | 9. Permit closeout | 10. conditional approval

Separate evidence from acceptance

F Say it

Area F has six inspection items: four recorded closed and two open. Revised information has been submitted for the open items. No occupancy permission is issued.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

06

WORD + PHRASE BANK

submitted / unissued / two / four

Coordinator: "The number recorded closed is ¹ _____."

Architect: "The number still open is ² _____."

Coordinator: "The revised information has been ³ _____."

Architect: "Occupancy permission remains ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 96

1. four | 2. two | 3. submitted | 4. unissued

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read the corrected conversation with Items 1-2 closed and Items 3-4 open.
2. Switch roles for turns 9-20; keep occupancy permission, a reinspection request, and a recorded acceptance distinct.
3. Read the checked Area F transfer twice. Four closures do not establish permission to occupy.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

A handover needs item-level evidence

A Read the situation

Transfer a closeout list with accurate status, ownership, and records rather than a misleading completion percentage.

A fictional closeout register for Level 2 contains eight punch-list items. Items 1 to 3 are completed and verified closed, with acceptance records linked. Items 4 to 8 are reported corrected by the trade contractors but still await review; they remain open under this project process. Outgoing coordinator Jules hands over to Meera. Meera accepts coordination of the five open reviews and will provide a status update at 16:00 Friday. No review outcome is guaranteed by that time. This eight-item list is not the full contract closeout package or proof of substantial completion.

PEOPLE / Jules: Outgoing closeout coordinator | Meera: Incoming closeout coordinator

COMPLETED HAS SEVERAL POSSIBLE MEANINGS

A trade contractor may use done to mean physical work has been performed. A coordinator may need verified acceptance before closing the record. Name both stages explicitly so a handover does not turn a report of correction into an unsupported sign-off.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. How many items are verified closed?

A Three

C Five

B Eight

D None

2. What is the status of Items 4 to 8?

A Proved defective after review

C Accepted as closed

B Reported corrected but still open pending review

D Removed from scope

3. What does Friday at 16:00 represent?

A Guaranteed closure of all five items

C Automatic substantial completion

B The start of every warranty

D Meera's status-update commitment

Answers and explanations: [page 97](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

punch list

A list of incomplete or corrective items tracked toward completion.

IN USE update the punch list

snagging

Identifying and recording incomplete or defective work, common in some regional usage.

IN USE carry out snagging

closeout register

A record tracking the items and evidence required for project closeout.

IN USE maintain the closeout register

deficiency

Work or information that does not meet a relevant requirement.

IN USE record a deficiency

rectification

Work performed to correct an identified problem.

IN USE report rectification

trade contractor

A contractor responsible for a particular trade or work package.

IN USE coordinate with the trade contractor

reported complete

Described as finished by a reporting party but not necessarily verified.

IN USE distinguish reported complete

verified closed

Confirmed complete under the relevant closure process.

IN USE mark an item verified closed

verification evidence

Information supporting a check of the claimed correction or completion.

IN USE link verification evidence

acceptance criteria

Conditions used to determine whether an item meets the required standard.

IN USE apply acceptance criteria

rework

Work repeated or altered because the original result is unacceptable.

IN USE track rework

workmanship

The quality of execution of construction work.

IN USE assess workmanship

Precision check

Three verified closures out of eight equal 37.5% of this list by count. That does not measure the total project by value, effort, safety significance, or readiness for use. Five reported corrections remain awaiting review.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

tolerance

The permitted variation from a specified dimension or performance.

IN USE verify the specified tolerance

mock-up

A sample construction or assembly used for review or testing.

IN USE compare with the approved mock-up

commissioning

A process for verifying and documenting that systems perform as required.

IN USE coordinate commissioning records

operation and maintenance manual

Information supporting operation, maintenance, and care of installed work or systems.

IN USE provide operation and maintenance manuals

record drawing

A drawing documenting relevant information about completed construction.

IN USE update record drawings

asset register

A structured inventory of assets and their relevant details.

IN USE populate the asset register

warranty

A stated undertaking concerning defects, performance, or remedy under applicable terms.

IN USE check warranty terms

defects liability period

A contract-defined period with specified obligations concerning defects.

IN USE verify the defects liability period

substantial completion

A contract-defined stage relating to readiness for the intended use.

IN USE determine substantial completion

final completion

The completion stage defined by the applicable contract requirements.

IN USE verify final completion

handover package

The collection of information and records transferred to the receiving party.

IN USE assemble the handover package

sign-off

Recorded acceptance or approval by the relevant authorized person.

IN USE obtain the required sign-off

Precision check

Punch-list closure, commissioning, manuals, record drawings, warranties, and contractual completion may involve different records and authorities. This small list does not replace the full closeout package or establish any warranty start date.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

STATE THE LIST SCOPE

"This register covers eight Level 2 punch-list items."

QUALIFY TRADE REPORTS

"Items 4 to 8 are reported corrected but await review."

LINK THE EVIDENCE

"Each closed item links to its acceptance record."

SEPARATE OWNERSHIP AND COMPLETION

"Accepting the handover does not close the items."

REPORT VERIFIED CLOSURE

"Items 1 to 3 are verified closed."

PRESERVE THE OPEN STATUS

"Those five items remain open under our process."

NAME THE RECEIVING OWNER

"Meera has accepted coordination of the five reviews."

STATE THE NEXT COMMITMENT

"I will provide a status update at 16:00 Friday."

Reported corrected

Attributes the claim without presenting it as verified acceptance.

Verified closed

Requires the specified closure basis, not an empty action column.

By count

Limits the percentage to the number of items.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

AVOID GUARANTEEING RESULTS

"That is an update time, not a promise of closure."

LIMIT THE METRIC

"That percentage does not describe the whole project."

KEEP DOCUMENTS TRACEABLE

"Preserve the item number, location, record, and review history."

AVOID ASSUMED WARRANTY TERMS

"Check the contract and relevant warranty documents."

QUALIFY THE PERCENTAGE

"Three of eight items is 37.5 percent by count."

CHECK THE CRITERION

"What evidence is required before this item can be closed?"

DISTINGUISH THE PACKAGE

"The punch list is only part of the closeout information."

CLOSE THE HANDOVER

"Please confirm receipt of the linked records and open-item responsibilities."

Accepted coordination

Means ownership of follow-up, not acceptance of the physical work.

At 16:00

Specifies the communication time, not the completion of every review.

Part of

Prevents one register from being mistaken for the entire closeout package.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which handover summary is correct?

- A** Eight closed because trades say done
- B** Five closed and three awaiting correction
- C** All items unreviewed with no records
- D** Three verified closed; five reported corrected and awaiting review

2. What is the verified closure rate by item count?

- A** 100%
- B** 37.5%
- C** 62.5%
- D** 80%

3. What does Meera's acceptance establish?

- A** Final completion of the whole project
- B** Ownership of coordinating the outstanding reviews
- C** Acceptance of all physical corrections
- D** A warranty start date

4. Which statement about the closeout package is supported?

- A** All warranties begin when an email is sent.
- B** Record drawings replace every inspection decision.
- C** This list alone does not establish full contractual closeout.
- D** Closing one punch item closes every permit.

Answers and explanations: [page 97](#).

A handover needs item-level evidence

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

handover package / verification evidence / sign-off / acceptance criteria / closeout register / substantial completion / Reported complete / warranty / punch list / deficiency

07

- 01 **Jules:** I want to hand over the eight-item Level 2 list properly. The summary saying almost done is too vague.
- 02 **Meera:** Let's use the ¹ _____ rather than that summary. Which items have completed the required review, and which are only reported corrected by the trade contractors?
- 03 **Jules:** Items 1 to 3 are completed and verified closed. Their acceptance records are linked. Items 4 to 8 have trade reports of correction but still await review.
- 04 **Meera:** Then those five remain open. ² _____ and verified closed are different stages. I do not want the handover to erase that distinction just because the physical work may be finished.
- 05 **Jules:** The trades uploaded photographs for all five pending items and asked me to close the rows. The reviewer has not responded yet.
- 06 **Meera:** An attachment may be ³ _____, but it is not the review result. We must check the applicable criterion and obtain the required decision before changing the closure status.
- 07 **Jules:** I preserved the item numbers, locations, earlier comments, and links to the latest submissions, so the reviewer can follow the history.
- 08 **Meera:** That will help us apply the ⁴ _____. Please make sure the receiving reviewer can find the original issue as well as the contractor's description of the correction.
- 09 **Jules:** The dashboard requests a completion percentage. Three divided by eight gives thirty-seven point five percent, but I hesitate to call the project thirty-seven point five percent complete.
- 10 **Meera:** You are right. It is the ⁵ _____ closure rate by count only. Items can differ greatly in effort, importance, and cost, and this list does not represent the whole project.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 64.

- 11 **Jules:** Can you accept coordination of the remaining five reviews? I want a named person rather than a note saying the project team will follow up.
- 12 **Meera:** Yes, I accept that responsibility. It is not ⁶ _____ on the corrections themselves. I will coordinate the reviews and provide a status update at sixteen hundred on Friday.
- 13 **Jules:** I will record the update commitment. If responses are still outstanding on Friday, the report needs to say so.
- 14 **Meera:** Exactly. If a ⁷ _____ remains, the update must preserve it and identify the next responsible action. We should not close an item to make the promised report look better.
- 15 **Jules:** Manuals and record drawings are in the separate closeout folder. I will include the link; this list does not track their review.
- 16 **Meera:** Link them in the ⁸ _____. A list of visible corrections is only one part of closeout. We must not imply that its completion settles every document or system obligation.
- 17 **Jules:** The client has asked whether this handover starts the warranties. I have not checked the relevant contract provisions or individual warranty terms.
- 18 **Meera:** Do not infer a ⁹ _____ start date from our coordination email. That needs the actual documents and authorized review, just as contractual completion status needs its own basis.
- 19 **Jules:** I will leave the record as three verified closures and five open reviews, with you as coordinator and Friday at sixteen hundred as the next status update.
- 20 **Meera:** I confirm that handover. It does not establish ¹⁰ _____ or final completion of the project. I will preserve the links and report the actual review outcomes as they become available.

07

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 98

1. closeout register | 2. Reported complete | 3. verification evidence | 4. acceptance criteria | 5. punch list | 6. sign-off | 7. deficiency | 8. handover package | 9. warranty | 10. substantial completion

Hand over a smaller register

F Say it

A six-item register has two verified closures and four reported corrections awaiting review. Coordinator Arun accepts follow-up and commits to an update at 11:00 Monday.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

two / coordination / 11:00 / four

Outgoing coordinator: "The number verified closed is ¹ _____."

Arun: "I will coordinate the ² _____ outstanding reviews."

Outgoing coordinator: "The next update is at ³ _____ Monday."

Arun: "My acceptance concerns ⁴ _____, not sign-off."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 98

1. two | 2. four | 3. 11:00 | 4. coordination

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read the corrected conversation, distinguishing three verified closures from five reported corrections.
2. Switch roles; describe 37.5 percent as an item-count rate and Friday 16:00 as an update commitment.
3. Read the checked transfer twice, with Arun accepting four reviews rather than approving the corrections.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

The delay is recorded; entitlement is not established

A Read the situation

Describe a delay and supporting records without presenting an unreviewed claim as a proven right.

Delivery records show that a project item arrived at the end of working Day 11 rather than the planned end of Day 6, a five-working-day difference. Commercial coordinator Saira has \$2,400 of reported extra labor costs, but the time records and causal link have not been reconciled. The impact on project completion, any concurrent delay, contract notice requirements, and entitlement to payment or time have not been reviewed. Project manager Theo finds a draft saying the delay automatically entitles us to compensation. They must prepare a factual internal summary for the authorized contract team, not make a legal determination.

PEOPLE / Saira: Commercial coordinator | Theo: Project manager

08

A CAREFUL CLAIM CAN STILL BE FIRM

Separating facts from an unreviewed entitlement does not surrender a position. It makes the request intelligible and prevents a confident phrase from outrunning the records. Legal effect depends on the actual contract and jurisdiction, not on the forcefulness of the writer.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What delivery variance is documented?

- A No difference from plan
- C Five calendar weeks

- B Five working days
- D Eleven working days late

2. What is the status of the \$2,400?

- A Accepted compensation
- C A contractual penalty already imposed

- B A verified measure of every project loss
- D Reported extra labor cost requiring reconciliation

3. What is not yet established?

- A The planned delivery day
- C Entitlement to payment or time

- B The existence of a draft claim statement
- D The actual delivery day

Answers and explanations: page 99.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

claim

A request or assertion seeking a contractual or legal remedy or entitlement.

IN USE substantiate a claim

entitlement

A right to a remedy or benefit under the applicable basis.

IN USE assess entitlement

causation

The connection between an event and a claimed consequence.

IN USE establish causation

quantum

The amount of a claimed or assessed monetary remedy.

IN USE assess quantum

contemporaneous record

A record made at or near the time of the relevant event.

IN USE preserve contemporaneous records

chronology

An ordered account of events and their dates or times.

IN USE prepare a chronology

delay event

An occurrence alleged or shown to affect progress or timing.

IN USE document a delay event

concurrent delay

Overlapping delay effects considered under the applicable contract and analysis.

IN USE assess concurrent delay

disruption

Interference with the planned manner or efficiency of performing work.

IN USE distinguish disruption from delay

prolongation

An extension of the time spent on a project or activity.

IN USE assess prolongation effects

mitigation

Reasonable measures to limit adverse effects under the relevant circumstances.

IN USE document mitigation measures

notice provision

A contract term governing notification of specified matters.

IN USE review the notice provisions

Precision check

A five-day delivery variance is not automatically a five-day delay to project completion. The schedule logic, available time, actual effects, and other events require analysis. An event record and a contractual entitlement answer different questions.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

time bar

A limitation linked to meeting a deadline under the applicable legal or contractual rules.

IN USE obtain advice on a time bar

reservation of rights

A statement intended to preserve a position, whose effect depends on the circumstances.

IN USE seek review of a reservation of rights

substantiation

Evidence and reasoning supporting an assertion or amount.

IN USE provide claim substantiation

cost reconciliation

Checking reported costs against supporting records and the relevant basis.

IN USE complete cost reconciliation

labor allocation

Assignment of labor time or cost to particular activities.

IN USE verify labor allocation

daily report

A record of the day's work, conditions, events, and resources.

IN USE consult the daily report

delivery docket

A record accompanying or confirming a delivery.

IN USE retain the delivery docket

correspondence register

An organized record of project communications.

IN USE update the correspondence register

liability

Legal responsibility determined under the applicable rules and facts.

IN USE distinguish alleged liability

disputed amount

A monetary figure whose validity or payment remains contested.

IN USE identify the disputed amount

settlement authority

Authority to agree a resolution on behalf of a party.

IN USE verify settlement authority

dispute resolution

The process for addressing disagreements under the applicable arrangement.

IN USE follow the dispute-resolution process

Precision check

The reported \$2,400 is not yet a reconciled claim amount or an accepted payment. Do not treat the words reservation of rights or without prejudice as universal protection. Obtain authorized contract and legal review for actual notices and positions.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

STATE THE EVENT

"Delivery occurred at the end of working Day 11."

QUANTIFY THE DIFFERENCE

"The recorded delivery variance is five working days."

SEPARATE THE COST STATUS

"Extra labor of two thousand four hundred dollars is reported but unreconciled."

DISTINGUISH CAUSATION

"We still need to establish which costs arose from this event."

GIVE THE REFERENCE

"The plan showed the end of working Day 6."

AVOID A COMPLETION INFERENCE

"The effect on project completion has not been assessed."

ASK FOR THE RECORDS

"Link the labor entries to the relevant work and dates."

KEEP ENTITLEMENT OPEN

"Entitlement to time or payment remains under review."

08

Reported

Attributes a cost figure without claiming verification.

Arising from

Makes a causal assertion that requires support.

Automatically entitled

Overstates an unreviewed contractual position.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

CORRECT THE DRAFT

"Remove automatically entitled from the unreviewed summary."

PRESERVE CHRONOLOGY

"Keep the planned date, actual date, and supporting delivery record together."

ADDRESS OTHER EVENTS

"Check whether other delays affected the same period."

RESPECT AUTHORITY

"I am not authorized to settle this dispute."

ROUTE CONTRACTUAL QUESTIONS

"The authorized team must review the contract and notice requirements."

AVOID RETROSPECTIVE CERTAINTY

"Do not rewrite an earlier observation as a later proven conclusion."

RECORD MITIGATION ACCURATELY

"Describe verified steps taken without inventing their effect."

CLOSE WITH A FACTUAL REQUEST

"Please review the event, claimed effect, records, and applicable contractual basis."

08

Variance versus delay to completion

A moved delivery date does not establish the whole project's movement.

Under review

Identifies an unresolved assessment, not a rejected claim.

Preserve

Means retain the original evidence and traceable updates, not alter it to strengthen a position.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which internal summary is supported?

- A** Five-day extension and \$2,400 compensation approved
- B** Supplier liable for all losses automatically
- C** No records exist because entitlement is uncertain
- D** Delivery five working days later than planned; completion impact and entitlement unreviewed

2. Which treatment of \$2,400 is appropriate?

- A** Delete supporting records once the total is typed.
- B** Label it reported and reconcile the labor records and causal basis.
- C** Call it accepted payment because it appears in a spreadsheet.
- D** Multiply it by five without a cost basis.

3. Which distinction is essential?

- A** A late delivery proves every claimed consequence.
- B** A chronology replaces the contract.
- C** Confident wording creates settlement authority.
- D** The event, its consequences, and entitlement are separate questions.

4. Who should assess actual notice requirements?

- A** A supplier who has not seen the contract
- B** The authorized contract team with appropriate legal review
- C** Any worker choosing the strongest phrase
- D** The PDF's fictional characters as legal advisers

Answers and explanations: [page 99](#).

The delay is recorded; entitlement is not established

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

cost reconciliation / chronology / causation / concurrent delay / Quantum / mitigation / contemporaneous records / entitlement / Settlement authority / notice provisions

08

- 01 **Theo:** The draft says the delay automatically entitles us to compensation. Before that goes anywhere, let's separate the event from the contractual conclusion.
- 02 **Saira:** The ¹ _____ is straightforward: planned arrival at the end of working Day 6, actual arrival at the end of Day 11. The delivery records support that difference.
- 03 **Theo:** So we can state a five-working-day delivery variance. We cannot yet state that project completion moved five days, because that effect has not been assessed.
- 04 **Saira:** Correct. We need the schedule analysis and any ² _____ review. The arrival dates alone do not show how every activity or the project completion point was affected.
- 05 **Theo:** The draft treats the two thousand four hundred dollars in extra labor as an established loss caused entirely by the late delivery. Is that supported?
- 06 **Saira:** It is reported cost, not completed ³ _____. I need to match the time entries to activities and dates, check for duplication, and establish what the figure actually includes.
- 07 **Theo:** Even if the arithmetic matches the records, we still need to explain why those costs resulted from this event rather than another activity.
- 08 **Saira:** Yes. That is the ⁴ _____ question. A correctly added spreadsheet does not prove the cause of every entry. We need a supported link, not simply costs occurring in the same week.
- 09 **Theo:** Please retain the original daily reports and delivery records. Do not rewrite the factual account to sound more decisive after our discussion.
- 10 **Saira:** I will preserve the ⁵ _____ and keep later analysis separate. Any correction needs a traceable explanation; it should not erase what was actually recorded at the time.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 73.

- 11 **Theo:** The site team says they sent an email. Please include it for contract review; we have not checked whether it meets the notice requirements.
- 12 **Saira:** Nor am I. The ⁶ _____ require authorized review of the actual contract and applicable rules. This internal summary should flag the question, not invent a deadline or prescribe a legal form.
- 13 **Theo:** I want the contract team to assess the possible claim, not read this as us dropping it. How do we label the unresolved right to a remedy?
- 14 **Saira:** State that ⁷ _____ remains under review and request assessment of the event, effects, and contractual basis. Accurate qualifications make the request clearer; they do not decide the ultimate position.
- 15 **Theo:** Even if a remedy exists, the reported figure may not be the recoverable amount. We need to distinguish the right to payment from its value.
- 16 **Saira:** Exactly. ⁸ _____ needs its own substantiation. The two thousand four hundred remains reported and unreconciled, and we should not label it agreed compensation or an accepted liability.
- 17 **Theo:** The internal package will include the chronology, delivery records, labor entries, unresolved schedule effects, and questions for authorized reviewers.
- 18 **Saira:** Include verified ⁹ _____ steps where the records support them. Do not assume that discussing a recovery option proves it was implemented or that it prevented a particular amount of loss.
- 19 **Theo:** I will remove the automatic-entitlement statement and circulate the factual summary internally. I will not offer a settlement or communicate a final legal conclusion.
- 20 **Saira:** Good. ¹⁰ _____ is separate from preparing records. We can make the event and unresolved questions precise while leaving contractual decisions with the people authorized to make them.

08

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 100

1. chronology | 2. concurrent delay | 3. cost reconciliation | 4. causation | 5. contemporaneous records | 6. notice provisions | 7. entitlement | 8. Quantum | 9. mitigation | 10. Settlement authority

Keep the three questions separate

F Say it

A delivery planned for the end of working Day 4 arrives at the end of Day 7. Reported additional labor is \$900. Completion impact, cost reconciliation, and entitlement are unreviewed.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

900 / unassessed / three / entitlement

08

Coordinator: "The delivery variance is ¹ _____ working days."

Manager: "The reported labor amount is \$ ² _____."

Coordinator: "The effect on project completion remains ³ _____."

Manager: "The right to a remedy is the ⁴ _____ question."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 100

1. three | 2. 900 | 3. unassessed | 4. entitlement

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read the corrected exchange, keeping the five-working-day delivery variance separate from completion impact.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20; distinguish reported \$2,400, causation, entitlement, and settlement authority.
3. Read the checked transfer twice with three working days and \$900 reported, without presenting either as an agreed remedy.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

A clash report is not an instruction to move a duct

E More workplace conversations / 1-10

Verify model references and distinguish a coordination issue from an authorized design change.

A coordination viewer flags duct D24 against beam B8 at Level 3. The structural model is revision S12; the loaded services file is M07, although M08 has been issued. Its alignment has not been checked. Issue C17 is open. No approved reroute exists, and this model review is not a fabrication or installation instruction.

PEOPLE / Nadia: BIM coordinator | Leo: Building-services engineer

Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Answers follow turn 20.

09

WORD + PHRASE BANK

viewpoint / fabrication release / geometric clash / federated model / shared coordinates / resolution status

- 01 **Nadia:** Issue C17 shows D24 passing through B8 at Level 3. Before the team reroutes anything, can we verify which models produced that view?
- 02 **Leo:** Yes. The structural file is S12, but the services file in the ¹ _____ is M07. Our issued services revision is M08.
- 03 **Nadia:** Then the screenshot may describe an older arrangement. I will record M07 as the checked version rather than imply the current design was tested.
- 04 **Leo:** Please load M08 through the coordination process and check the ² _____ before rerunning the check. We have not verified alignment in this review yet.
- 05 **Nadia:** I will also retain the old result. Replacing the file should not erase the explanation of why C17 was raised.
- 06 **Leo:** Agreed. Attach both model revisions and the check date to the issue. A later reviewer needs to reproduce the same comparison, not guess from the thumbnail.
- 07 **Nadia:** If the intersection remains after those checks, should I mark it as a confirmed site defect?
- 08 **Leo:** No. It would establish a model ³ _____ under the checked conditions. Whether it represents an actual design conflict or installed condition still needs the relevant review.
- 09 **Nadia:** The meeting note says move the duct down one hundred millimetres. Was that a design instruction or someone's suggestion?
- 10 **Leo:** A suggestion only. We have not checked the implications for ceiling space, supports, access, or other services, and nobody has issued an approved reroute.

The conversation, continued

E More workplace conversations / 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 76.

- 11 **Nadia:** I will label it proposed in C17. Can you take ownership of evaluating it with the other disciplines?
- 12 **Leo:** Yes. Give me the issue with its ⁴ _____, element identifiers, level, and model revisions. I will coordinate the design review, not authorize installation through a meeting comment.
- 13 **Nadia:** The team uses BIM Collaboration Format for issues. I can attach the saved view and the question to the existing C17 entry.
- 14 **Leo:** That is useful. Keep the responsible reviewer and requested response date there too; the issue record supports coordination but does not replace the design documents.
- 15 **Nadia:** Should the contractor fabricate to the suggested route while your review runs, to protect the lead time?
- 16 **Leo:** This exchange provides no ⁵ _____. The contractor needs the actual authorized information under the project process, not my agreement to review an option.
- 17 **Nadia:** If M08 removes the intersection, I will still record what changed and ask for the required verification before closing C17.
- 18 **Leo:** Exactly. Do not close it solely because the red marker disappears. Check the issue against its stated concern and record the relevant review result.
- 19 **Nadia:** Current action: verify M08 and alignment, rerun the coordination check, and send you the reproducible issue record if it remains.
- 20 **Leo:** I accept that review. Keep the ⁶ _____ open until the applicable check supports a change, with any resulting design instruction handled separately.

09

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 101

1. federated model | 2. shared coordinates | 3. geometric clash | 4. viewpoint | 5. fabrication release | 6. resolution status

The screenshot uses an older discipline model

F Say it in a new situation

Issue C29 links pipe P6 and beam B12 on Level 2. The viewer used services revision M03; M04 is current. Alignment is unverified. Engineer Rosa accepts the design review; no reroute is approved.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

alignment / M04 / Rosa / approved

09

Coordinator: The current services revision to verify is ¹ _____.

Engineer: First verify model ² _____ before interpreting the apparent intersection.

Coordinator: The assigned design reviewer is ³ _____.

Engineer: The proposed reroute is not yet ⁴ _____.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 101

1. M04 | 2. alignment | 3. Rosa | 4. approved

Read, switch, repeat

1. Check the four answers and read the complete exchange aloud.
2. Switch roles. Read it again with the word bank covered.
3. Return to the extended conversation. Read turns 1-10, then switch roles for turns 11-20. Use the corrected expressions.

SOLO PRACTICE

Read both roles. Pause briefly at each change of speaker. Repeat any line that needed an answer check.

The color sample did not approve a different product

E More workplace conversations / 1-10

Separate an appearance selection from technical substitution review and purchasing authority.

The fictional project specifies acoustic panel P200. The architect accepted sample finish B for color only. A supplier proposes P240 in the same color with a shorter quoted lead time. Its acoustic evidence, fire-performance documentation, mounting details, warranty, and substitution approval are unverified. No order for P240 has been authorized.

PEOPLE / Mina: Procurement coordinator | Elias: Project architect

Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Answers follow turn 20.

10

WORD + PHRASE BANK

applicability / quoted lead-time saving / review scope / decision record / substitution proposal / commercial commitment

- 01 **Mina:** The supplier can deliver P240 sooner than P200, and the color matches the sample you accepted. Can I place the order today?
- 02 **Elias:** Not on the sample approval alone. That ¹ _____ covered finish B for color. It did not approve P240 as a replacement for the specified panel.
- 03 **Mina:** The sales email calls it equal, but the attachment only shows the finish options. I cannot find the acoustic report.
- 04 **Elias:** Please request a documented ² _____. It needs to identify the proposed product and its differences, rather than rely on the word equal.
- 05 **Mina:** I will ask for a side-by-side comparison against the actual project requirements. Should the supplier include mounting details as well as the panel data?
- 06 **Elias:** Yes. Performance and installation information need review together. Matching the face color does not establish whether the proposed system meets the requirements.
- 07 **Mina:** They have sent a fire-performance document bearing the manufacturer's name, but I cannot tell which product or configuration it covers.
- 08 **Elias:** Then its ³ _____ is unverified. Ask for the product and configuration covered; do not treat a familiar logo as evidence for this assembly.
- 09 **Mina:** The supplier says the acoustic rating is close enough. I do not have the test method or the mounting arrangement behind that number.
- 10 **Elias:** We need those details for comparison with the specification. Similar numbers from different tested arrangements are not automatically interchangeable.

The conversation, continued

E More workplace conversations / 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 79.

- 11 **Mina:** What about the lead time? P200 is quoted at six weeks and P240 at four, but neither production slot is reserved.
- 12 **Elias:** Describe the two-week difference as a ⁴ _____, not a confirmed delivery gain. The technical review and availability still need to be resolved.
- 13 **Mina:** There is also a proposed price reduction. I will show it separately from any change in mounting costs or warranty terms.
- 14 **Elias:** Good. The reviewer needs the full proposed effect, including exclusions. A lower unit price is not proof that the total installed cost will fall.
- 15 **Mina:** The supplier offered to reserve stock if I send a purchase order marked subject to approval. Would that keep the decision open?
- 16 **Elias:** Do not assume that wording avoids a ⁵ _____. Check the proposed reservation and order terms with the authorized commercial team before committing.
- 17 **Mina:** For the register, I will record finish B accepted for color, P240 substitution under review, and purchasing authorization absent.
- 18 **Elias:** That is accurate. Link the comparison and supporting documents to the substitution entry so the required reviewers can respond to the same proposal.
- 19 **Mina:** When a decision arrives, I will verify exactly which product and configuration it covers before I update the purchasing instruction.
- 20 **Elias:** Yes. Retain the ⁶ _____ and any conditions. For now, keep the alternative unapproved and the two quoted lead times separate from delivery promises.

10

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 102

1. review scope | 2. substitution proposal | 3. applicability | 4. quoted lead-time saving | 5. commercial commitment | 6. decision record

A finish selection has a limited scope

F Say it in a new situation

Specified product Q10 has an accepted color sample, finish C. Supplier alternative Q12 quotes three weeks rather than Q10's five. Technical evidence and substitution approval are pending, and no production slot or purchase is confirmed.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

two / C / Q12 / pending

Coordinator: The sample acceptance concerns finish ¹ _____ only.

Architect: The proposed alternative is product ² _____.

Coordinator: The quoted lead-time difference is ³ _____ weeks.

Architect: Technical acceptance of the substitution remains ⁴ _____.

10

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 102

1. C | 2. Q12 | 3. two | 4. pending

Read, switch, repeat

1. Check the four answers and read the complete exchange aloud.
2. Switch roles. Read it again with the word bank covered.
3. Return to the extended conversation. Read turns 1-10, then switch roles for turns 11-20. Use the corrected expressions.

SOLO PRACTICE

Read both roles. Pause briefly at each change of speaker. Repeat any line that needed an answer check.

Cumulative value is not this month's payment

E More workplace conversations / 1-10

Reconcile completed work, eligible stored materials, retainage, and previous certified amounts.

Fictional terms: completed work \$90,000; separately eligible presently stored materials \$10,000; retainage 5% on both; previous certificates \$60,000. No other deductions, taxes, or adjustments apply. An unapproved \$5,000 change proposal is excluded. This application still requires certification.

PEOPLE / Priya: Contractor's quantity surveyor | Sam: Contract-administration coordinator

Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Answers follow turn 20.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

current amount requested / valuation date / double counting / cumulative valuation / previous certificates / retainage

11

- 01 **Priya:** The draft requests one hundred thousand dollars this month. That is the completed-and-stored total, but it looks as though we have missed the earlier certificates.
- 02 **Sam:** Yes. We need a ¹ _____ first, then apply the stated deductions and prior certified amount. Show the two components separately.
- 03 **Priya:** Completed work is ninety thousand. Eligible materials presently stored are ten thousand, separate from the installed work. Together they make one hundred thousand to date.
- 04 **Sam:** Five percent ² _____ on both components is five thousand. That leaves ninety-five thousand before we deduct prior certificates.
- 05 **Priya:** Previous certificates total sixty thousand. Ninety-five thousand less sixty thousand leaves thirty-five thousand for this application.
- 06 **Sam:** Correct. Thirty-five thousand is the ³ _____, subject to certification. It is not a payment already made.
- 07 **Priya:** The accounts team has only received fifty thousand against the earlier sixty thousand certified. Should we subtract cash received instead, to include the unpaid ten thousand again?
- 08 **Sam:** No. This calculation subtracts ⁴ _____. Track that unpaid ten thousand separately; do not request it twice as new work.
- 09 **Priya:** I will reconcile that receivable with accounts. There is also a five-thousand-dollar change proposal in the draft schedule.
- 10 **Sam:** Keep that pending proposal outside this application's supplied basis. Adding it to a spreadsheet would not establish approval.

The conversation, continued

E More workplace conversations / 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 82.

- 11 **Priya:** The stored-materials line has supporting eligibility records. I have also checked that these materials are not included in the ninety thousand of installed work.
- 12 **Sam:** Good. That avoids ⁵ _____. The same value cannot remain in presently stored materials after it has also been included in completed work.
- 13 **Priya:** If those materials are incorporated next period, we need to move their existing value to completed work, not add that value a second time.
- 14 **Sam:** Exactly. Any newly earned installation value is a separate supported item. Reclassifying the same material alone does not create another entitlement to its purchase value.
- 15 **Priya:** Can I assume five percent also applies on the next project? The templates look identical.
- 16 **Sam:** No. Verify that project's contract and applicable requirements. Retainage rates, eligible stored materials, reductions, and other deductions can differ even when the form looks familiar.
- 17 **Priya:** I will attach the line-item reconciliation and distinguish this period's request from the cumulative totals and the earlier unpaid balance.
- 18 **Sam:** Also preserve the ⁶ _____. Otherwise, an invoice received later could be mistaken for value that belonged in this period.
- 19 **Priya:** The corrected summary is one hundred thousand eligible to date, five thousand retained, sixty thousand previously certified, and thirty-five thousand now requested.
- 20 **Sam:** That reconciles under the supplied terms. Send it through the required review, with the earlier unpaid ten thousand tracked separately and no suggestion that the new amount is already certified.

11

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 103

1. cumulative valuation | 2. retainage | 3. current amount requested | 4. previous certificates | 5. double counting | 6. valuation date

Subtract certification, not only cash receipts

F Say it in a new situation

A fictional application has \$70,000 completed and \$10,000 separately eligible stored materials to date. Retainage is 5% on both. Previous certificates total \$50,000, of which \$45,000 is paid. No other adjustments apply. Deduct previous certificates in the new request.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

4,000 / 5,000 / 80,000 / 26,000

11

Surveyor: Total eligible completed and stored value is \$¹ _____.

Coordinator: The stated retainage is \$² _____.

Surveyor: The new request, before certification, is \$³ _____.

Coordinator: The earlier certified but unpaid balance is \$⁴ _____.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 103

1. 80,000 | 2. 4,000 | 3. 26,000 | 4. 5,000

Read, switch, repeat

1. Check the four answers and read the complete exchange aloud.
2. Switch roles. Read it again with the word bank covered.
3. Return to the extended conversation. Read turns 1-10, then switch roles for turns 11-20. Use the corrected expressions.

SOLO PRACTICE

Read both roles. Pause briefly at each change of speaker. Repeat any line that needed an answer check.

01 Briefing and language checks

Design Intent and Client Requirements

A Briefing checks / page 4

1. Which use pattern does Amira request?

C. Two arrangements used at different times

The brief distinguishes a twelve-person workshop from a separate twenty-four-person presentation.

2. What does the 15-minute figure describe?

D. A requested furniture-change target

Fifteen minutes is the requested changeover target, not a tested or approved performance result.

3. Which statement about capacity is supported?

C. The requested numbers still need design and code review.

Requested user numbers do not establish a compliant layout or an approved occupant load.

D Language checks / page 9

1. Which brief statement is most precise?

B. Twelve-person workshops and twenty-four-person presentations at different times

The precise statement identifies both user numbers and the separate timing of the activities.

2. Which claim goes beyond the facts?

A. The room is already approved for twenty-four occupants.

The client request does not establish an approved occupant load or compliant design.

3. Which question clarifies the changeover requirement?

C. Who moves the furniture, and where does unused furniture go?

Staffing and storage directly affect the fifteen-minute changeover; the other questions address different design needs.

4. Which response addresses remote participants?

A. Assess sound capture from the room, not just the display.

Hearing questions depends on the audio arrangement, not simply the presence of a screen.

01 Conversation answers

Design Intent and Client Requirements

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 10-11

1. client brief. Turn 2. The client brief records the intended users, activities, and requirements before a specific solution is confirmed.

2. seating arrangements. Turn 4. The seating arrangements describe how seats relate to each activity; they do not establish approved occupancy or feasibility.

3. changeover time. Turn 6. Changeover time is the duration needed to move between the requested arrangements, here a target of fifteen minutes.

4. circulation. Turn 8. Circulation concerns movement through the space; stored furniture must not be assumed to fit without assessing its effect on routes.

5. microphone coverage. Turn 10. Microphone coverage addresses capturing sound from the required locations, rather than merely displaying images or slides.

6. speech intelligibility. Turn 12. Speech intelligibility describes how clearly the spoken words can be understood, beyond the mere presence of an audio signal.

7. occupant load. Turn 14. Occupant load requires the applicable code determination; the requested number of seats is not that approval.

8. sightlines. Turn 16. Sightlines describe the views from seating positions to the presentation area and must be assessed in the proposed layouts.

9. design constraints. Turn 18. Design constraints are conditions limiting the solution; identifying them prevents unresolved matters from being treated as settled design decisions.

10. functional requirements. Turn 20. Functional requirements state what the space is intended to enable, while the design and review process establishes how that can be achieved.

F Transfer conversation

Page 12

1. 10

Client: "The workshop needs 10 places."

Ten is the requested workshop capacity in the supplied brief.

2. 18

Architect: "The presentation request is 18 seats."

Eighteen refers to presentation seating, not the workshop arrangement.

3. 20

Client: "The target changeover is 20 minutes."

Twenty minutes is the requested duration for changing arrangements.

4. requested

Architect: "Those capacities remain requested, not approved."

The brief explicitly says no capacity approval has been established.

02 Briefing and language checks

Drawings, Specifications, and RFIs

A Briefing checks / page 13

1. Where is the discrepancy?

D. The same wall in Room 205

Both references identify different finishes for the same wall in Room 205.

2. Which finish can Lena select from the supplied facts?

B. Neither; an authorized clarification is required.

The case supplies no precedence rule or authorized decision resolving the conflict.

3. What does Tuesday at 14:00 mean?

A. The requested response time

The requested date communicates a need without guaranteeing an answer or lifting the hold.

D Language checks / page 18

1. Which RFI description is strongest?

B. Room 205 wall: A601 rev C says F2; S09 rev B says F3. Please confirm the required finish.

The specific request identifies the location, conflict, references, and decision required.

2. What follows from both references being current?

A. The conflict still requires clarification.

Current issue status does not by itself resolve contradictory requirements.

3. What should happen if the reply adds cost or time?

A. Use the applicable change-authorization process.

Clarification and authorization of changed commercial effects are distinct project decisions.

4. Which update is supported before a reply arrives?

A. RFI open; affected finish procurement on hold; response requested Tuesday at 14:00.

This update preserves the actual open status, limited hold, and requested response time.

02 Conversation answers

Drawings, Specifications, and RFIs

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 19-20

- 1. document references.** Turn 2. Document references identify the exact sources of the conflict so the response can address the same location and information.
- 2. clarification.** Turn 4. Clarification resolves the uncertain requirement; the current documents alone do not establish whether F2 or F3 is correct.
- 3. document precedence.** Turn 6. Document precedence concerns the applicable authority of conflicting documents, which has not been established in the supplied case.
- 4. substitution.** Turn 8. A substitution is a proposed alternative to the requirement; preference or availability does not establish approval.
- 5. response date.** Turn 10. The response date is requested here, not a promise by Marco or a condition that automatically releases procurement.
- 6. RFI log.** Turn 12. The RFI log tracks the request, its references, response, and current status so another person can follow the decision.
- 7. change authorization.** Turn 14. Change authorization addresses permission for altered work and its relevant effects; it is not automatically supplied by an RFI clarification.
- 8. controlled distribution.** Turn 16. Controlled distribution provides recipients with the applicable document issue and helps prevent use of outdated conflicting information.
- 9. traceability.** Turn 18. Traceability allows the team to follow the final requirement back through the documented decision and affected references.
- 10. procurement hold.** Turn 20. The procurement hold remains in effect for the affected finish until the authorized process resolves the discrepancy and permits the next action.

F Transfer conversation

Page 21

1. 310

Coordinator: "The affected room is 310."

The supplied discrepancy concerns Room 310, not Room 205.

2. C1

Architect: "The drawing identifies ceiling finish C1."

C1 is the designation in the supplied drawing reference.

3. C4

Coordinator: "The specification identifies C4."

C4 is the conflicting designation in the supplied specification.

4. unconfirmed

Architect: "The required finish remains unconfirmed."

The case explicitly provides no decision resolving the two requirements.

03 Briefing and language checks

Change Orders and Cost Control

03

A Briefing checks / page 22

1. What is the current approved contract sum?

D. \$105,000

The original \$100,000 plus the approved \$5,000 addition equals \$105,000.

2. What has the client authorized in this case?

A. Preparation of pricing only

The client requested a price, while the proposed cost and time remain unaccepted.

3. What is the status of the two working days?

C. An estimated effect subject to review

The estimator supplies a provisional time estimate, not an agreed contract adjustment.

D Language checks / page 27

1. Which cost summary is correct?

C. Approved \$105,000; proposed addition \$6,200; hypothetical total \$111,200

The summary preserves both the existing approved value and the separate unaccepted proposal.

2. Which minutes correction is appropriate?

B. Replace approved the partition with requested pricing for the partition.

The corrected wording matches the actual action requested rather than inventing an approval.

3. What does an estimated two-day effect establish?

A. A provisional schedule assessment

An estimate remains subject to review and does not itself amend contractual time.

4. Which statement respects different contracts?

A. Check the applicable mechanism and actual instruction; none is issued here.

The case describes one authorization status without imposing a universal rule on other contracts.

03 Conversation answers

Change Orders and Cost Control

03

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 28-29

- 1. proposal request.** Turn 2. A proposal request asks for terms or pricing; it is not the client's acceptance of the proposed work.
- 2. net addition.** Turn 4. The net addition is the already approved increase, giving a current contract sum of \$105,000 before the new proposal.
- 3. contract sum.** Turn 6. The contract sum reflects the original agreement and approved adjustments, not a proposal still awaiting acceptance.
- 4. cost breakdown.** Turn 8. The cost breakdown itemizes the elements behind the proposed price so the reviewer can examine its basis.
- 5. time impact.** Turn 10. Time impact is the assessed schedule effect; the two-day figure remains an estimate rather than an agreed extension.
- 6. pricing assumptions.** Turn 12. Pricing assumptions are the conditions underlying the estimate; changing them may alter what the quoted price covers.
- 7. commitment.** Turn 14. A commitment can create an obligation such as a purchase; it must not be assumed permissible merely because the work is still proposed.
- 8. change register.** Turn 16. The change register tracks the proposal separately from approved changes, preserving its pending status for later review.
- 9. quotation validity.** Turn 18. Quotation validity identifies the period and terms under which the offer remains available, rather than assuming an estimate lasts indefinitely.
- 10. authorization to proceed.** Turn 20. Authorization to proceed is permission to start specified work; the supplied case explicitly has no such instruction.

F Transfer conversation

Page 30

1. 84,000

Manager: "The current approved sum is \$84,000."

The original eighty thousand plus four thousand approved equals eighty-four thousand.

2. 3,000

Estimator: "The pending proposal is \$3,000."

Three thousand is the separate proposal that remains unaccepted.

3. 87,000

Manager: "If accepted, the revised sum would be \$87,000."

Adding the pending three thousand to eighty-four thousand gives eighty-seven thousand.

4. unaccepted

Estimator: "The proposed change remains unaccepted."

The supplied facts explicitly say the new proposal has not been accepted.

04 Briefing and language checks

Schedule, Sequencing, and Critical Path

04

A Briefing checks / page 31

1. With the stated dependencies, when can installation occur?

A. Days 4 and 5

Delivery finishes at the end of Day 3, so two full installation days follow.

2. When does testing move to?

A. Day 6

Testing requires completed installation, which now finishes at the end of Day 5.

3. What has been established about recovery?

D. No recovery option has been verified.

The brief provides no verified way to shorten or overlap the activities.

D Language checks / page 36

1. Which sequence follows the supplied facts?

D. Delivery ends Day 3; installation Days 4-5; testing Day 6

The finish-to-start links and unchanged durations produce testing on Day 6.

2. How should the schedule records be handled?

A. Preserve the baseline and update the current lookahead.

The baseline supports comparison while the lookahead must represent the supported upcoming sequence.

3. What is the variance in testing?

B. Two working days later

Testing moves from Day 4 to Day 6, a difference of two working days.

4. Which contractual conclusion is supported?

B. None is established by this calculation alone.

Forecast arithmetic alone does not determine contractual responsibility, relief, or payment.



04 Conversation answers

Schedule, Sequencing, and Critical Path

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 37-38

- 1. lookahead schedule.** Turn 2. The lookahead schedule is the short-term upcoming plan and must reflect the changed delivery forecast rather than obsolete dates.
- 2. finish-to-start relationship.** Turn 4. The finish-to-start relationship requires the preceding activity to finish before its successor begins, so installation follows the completed delivery.
- 3. activity duration.** Turn 6. Activity duration is the time needed for the task; installation remains two full working days in the supplied facts.
- 4. recovery plan.** Turn 8. A recovery plan needs a feasible method for regaining time; simply retaining the old target does not demonstrate recovery.
- 5. resource availability.** Turn 10. Resource availability concerns whether the people, equipment, and other inputs needed for a recovery proposal can actually be provided.
- 6. calendar basis.** Turn 12. The calendar basis identifies which periods count for scheduling; here all numbered days are working days rather than unqualified calendar days.
- 7. baseline schedule.** Turn 14. The baseline schedule remains the reference plan for comparing the original timing with the current forecast.
- 8. schedule variance.** Turn 16. Schedule variance is the difference between the reference and updated timing, here testing moving from Day 4 to Day 6.
- 9. extension of time.** Turn 18. An extension of time is a contractual adjustment requiring the applicable basis and process, not an automatic consequence of forecast arithmetic.
- 10. forecast date.** Turn 20. The forecast date states the currently expected timing under the available information, while retaining uncertainty and the separate baseline reference.

F Transfer conversation

Page 39

1. 6

Planner: "Installation begins on Day 6."

The first full working day after the end of Day 5 is Day 6.

2. 7

Manager: "Its second day is Day 7."

Two full installation days are Days 6 and 7.

3. 8

Planner: "Testing therefore occurs on Day 8."

Testing follows completed installation, so it occurs on Day 8.

4. overlap

Manager: "The dependency permits no overlap."

The supplied facts expressly rule out overlapping the activities.

05 Briefing and language checks

Site Safety and Toolbox Talks

A Briefing checks / page 40

1. What is missing from the card?

A. The task-specific approved method, controls, and equipment requirements

The generic instruction does not supply the actual approved requirements for this task.

2. What is the affected task's current status?

B. Stopped under the local process

Rosa has stopped the affected activity pending the required qualified clarification.

3. What can experience on another site establish here?

D. It does not by itself establish the requirements for this task.

Different materials, tools, and conditions require the applicable task assessment rather than an assumed match.

D Language checks / page 45

1. Which clarification is most useful?

A. Which approved method and controls apply to cutting these panels in Zone B?

The question identifies the task and asks for applicable approved requirements rather than a guess.

2. Which statement about controls is accurate?

C. PPE requirements belong within the applicable wider control arrangement.

Protective equipment does not replace assessing and applying the relevant task controls.

3. Which repeat-back matches the facts?

C. The task is stopped; qualified clarification and restart authorization are pending.

Receipt or attendance does not satisfy the missing clarification and authorization requirements.

4. What should Rosa avoid?

C. Inventing equipment requirements to complete the card

The case requires qualified task-specific clarification, not improvised protective-equipment selection.

05 Conversation answers

Site Safety and Toolbox Talks

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 46-47

1. task briefing. Turn 2. The task briefing needs applicable requirements; the generic phrase does not identify the method or controls.

2. risk assessment. Turn 4. The risk assessment addresses this task's conditions and controls; experience elsewhere does not establish its findings.

3. Personal protective equipment. Turn 6. Personal protective equipment protects against specified hazards but does not replace the wider task-control arrangement.

4. method statement. Turn 8. The method statement describes the planned method and controls; a similar title does not establish task applicability.

5. briefing record. Turn 10. A briefing record documents participation or the briefing; attendance alone establishes neither understanding nor authorization.

6. repeat-back. Turn 12. A repeat-back checks the listener's understanding of the task status and next requirement, beyond a vague acknowledgement.

7. stop-work instruction. Turn 14. The stop-work instruction identifies the halted activity and remains effective while clarification and authorization are pending.

8. restart conditions. Turn 16. Restart conditions must be satisfied before resumption; schedule pressure or uncertain timing does not remove them.

9. hierarchy of controls. Turn 18. The hierarchy of controls orders risk-control approaches; it does not treat PPE as the sole or preferred answer.

10. toolbox talk. Turn 20. The toolbox talk communicates the established task requirements; attendance does not replace the required restart authorization.

F Transfer conversation

Page 48

1. D

Foreperson: "The affected location is Zone D."

Zone D is the location supplied for this separate task.

2. stopped

Coordinator: "The task is currently stopped."

The brief explicitly states that the lifting task is stopped.

3. Sana

Foreperson: "The named review owner is Sana."

Sana is the coordinator assigned to obtain the missing review.

4. unauthorized

Coordinator: "A restart remains unauthorized."

The supplied facts explicitly say no restart has been authorized.

05

06 Briefing and language checks

Permitting, Inspections, and Code Issues

A Briefing checks / page 49

1. How many inspection items are recorded closed?

A. Two

The supplied record closes Items 1 and 2 while Items 3 and 4 remain open.

2. What do the photographs establish about Items 3 and 4?

C. Evidence was submitted, but acceptance is not recorded.

Submission of photographs is not the same as recorded acceptance of the corrections.

3. Which occupancy statement is supported?

C. No permission is issued in the supplied case.

The brief explicitly states that no occupancy permission has been issued for Area C.

D Language checks / page 54

1. Which progress statement is accurate?

B. Two items closed; two open with photographs submitted; no occupancy permission issued.

The statement distinguishes recorded closure, submitted evidence, and the separate occupancy status.

2. What can 2 out of 4 measure here?

D. Fifty percent of the listed item count

The numerator and denominator describe listed items, not area, cost, or regulatory permission.

3. Which evidence would support changing an item's status?

B. The relevant documented acceptance or closure decision

Status should reflect the relevant decision rather than merely evidence delivery or confidence.

4. Which question makes approved precise?

D. What was approved, by whom, and in which record?

Scope, authority, and the decision record establish approval; email timing, attachment counts, and forecasts do not.

06 Conversation answers

Permitting, Inspections, and Code Issues

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 55-56

- 1. inspection status.** Turn 2. Inspection status must match the record; two open items cannot become full approval through a broad summary.
- 2. supporting evidence.** Turn 4. Supporting evidence may substantiate a correction; its submission is not the authority's acceptance or closure decision.
- 3. approval scope.** Turn 6. Approval scope limits the decision to its actual subject; closing specific items does not approve the whole area.
- 4. Code compliance.** Turn 8. Code compliance concerns applicable requirements; counting closed items does not measure a percentage of legal compliance or usable area.
- 5. occupancy permission.** Turn 10. Occupancy permission is a separate jurisdictional authorization, which the supplied facts say has not been issued.
- 6. authority having jurisdiction.** Turn 12. The authority having jurisdiction is responsible for the relevant regulatory decision; the project team cannot assume that authority.
- 7. reinspection.** Turn 14. Reinspection is a further inspection; a request establishes neither a confirmed appointment nor a successful result.
- 8. acceptance record.** Turn 16. The acceptance record documents the reviewer's decision, providing the basis for marking the specified item accepted or closed.
- 9. Permit closeout.** Turn 18. Permit closeout concerns the regulatory record and steps; a contractual milestone does not replace that jurisdictional process.
- 10. conditional approval.** Turn 20. Conditional approval remains limited by its conditions; a shortened summary must preserve them and the actual scope.

F Transfer conversation

Page 57

- 1. four**
Coordinator: "The number recorded closed is four."
Four of the six listed items have documented closure.
- 2. two**
Architect: "The number still open is two."
The remaining two items are explicitly identified as open.
- 3. submitted**
Coordinator: "The revised information has been submitted."
The brief establishes submission, not acceptance of the revised information.
- 4. unissued**
Architect: "Occupancy permission remains unissued."
The supplied case explicitly says no occupancy permission is issued.

06

07 Briefing and language checks

Quality, Punch List, and Closeout

A Briefing checks / page 58

1. How many items are verified closed?

A. Three

Only Items 1 to 3 have both completion and linked acceptance records.

2. What is the status of Items 4 to 8?

B. Reported corrected but still open pending review

Trade reports of correction do not satisfy the fictional process's review requirement.

3. What does Friday at 16:00 represent?

D. Meera's status-update commitment

Meera commits to reporting the status, not to achieving a particular review outcome.

D Language checks / page 63

1. Which handover summary is correct?

D. Three verified closed; five reported corrected and awaiting review

The summary preserves the distinction between accepted closure and unverified correction reports.

2. What is the verified closure rate by item count?

B. 37.5%

Three divided by eight equals 0.375, or 37.5 percent.

3. What does Meera's acceptance establish?

B. Ownership of coordinating the outstanding reviews

Meera accepts the coordination task, not every technical or contractual decision.

4. Which statement about the closeout package is supported?

C. This list alone does not establish full contractual closeout.

The eight-item register is explicitly only part of the broader closeout information.

07 Conversation answers

Quality, Punch List, and Closeout

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 64-65

- 1. closeout register.** Turn 2. The closeout register records item-level status and evidence, separating verified closure from outstanding review.
- 2. Reported complete.** Turn 4. Reported complete attributes a claim to the reporting party; it does not establish required verification or acceptance.
- 3. verification evidence.** Turn 6. Verification evidence supports review of the work; an uploaded file does not itself supply an acceptance decision.
- 4. acceptance criteria.** Turn 8. Acceptance criteria determine whether a correction meets requirements, not merely whether someone has attempted the work.
- 5. punch list.** Turn 10. The punch list is the eight-item register counted here; its closure rate does not measure overall project completion.
- 6. sign-off.** Turn 12. Sign-off is recorded acceptance or approval; accepting responsibility for review coordination is a different action.
- 7. deficiency.** Turn 14. A deficiency fails a relevant requirement and may still need correction despite a trade's report of completion.
- 8. handover package.** Turn 16. The handover package includes the relevant records; this punch list alone does not cover all closeout information.
- 9. warranty.** Turn 18. A warranty has applicable terms; handing over this register does not establish its start date or coverage.
- 10. substantial completion.** Turn 20. Substantial completion is contract-defined; accepting this register or counting closed items does not establish that stage.

F Transfer conversation

Page 66

1. two

Outgoing coordinator: "The number verified closed is two."

Two is the supplied count of items with verified closure.

2. four

Arun: "I will coordinate the four outstanding reviews."

Four reported corrections still require review under the supplied status.

3. 11:00

Outgoing coordinator: "The next update is at 11:00 Monday."

Eleven on Monday is the stated update time, not guaranteed closure.

4. coordination

Arun: "My acceptance concerns coordination, not sign-off."

Arun accepts follow-up responsibility without accepting the physical work.

07

08 Briefing and language checks

Claims, Disputes, and Documentation

A Briefing checks / page 67

1. What delivery variance is documented?

B. Five working days

The arrival moved from the end of Day 6 to the end of Day 11.

2. What is the status of the \$2,400?

D. Reported extra labor cost requiring reconciliation

The cost is reported, but its records and causal connection have not been reconciled.

3. What is not yet established?

C. Entitlement to payment or time

Contractual entitlement and the effect on project completion remain unreviewed in the supplied facts.

D Language checks / page 72

1. Which internal summary is supported?

D. Delivery five working days later than planned; completion impact and entitlement unreviewed

The summary states the known event while preserving the unresolved schedule and contractual questions.

2. Which treatment of \$2,400 is appropriate?

B. Label it reported and reconcile the labor records and causal basis.

The supplied amount needs reconciliation and a supported connection to the event before stronger claims.

3. Which distinction is essential?

D. The event, its consequences, and entitlement are separate questions.

Evidence of an event does not alone establish its effects or the right to a remedy.

4. Who should assess actual notice requirements?

B. The authorized contract team with appropriate legal review

Actual notice obligations depend on the contract and jurisdiction and require appropriate authorized review.

08 Conversation answers

Claims, Disputes, and Documentation

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 73-74

1. chronology. Turn 2. The chronology records event order and timing, here the planned and actual delivery dates, without determining entitlement.

2. concurrent delay. Turn 4. Concurrent delay concerns overlapping delay effects; the possible effects of other events remain unreviewed here.

3. cost reconciliation. Turn 6. Cost reconciliation checks reported costs against their supporting records and basis; the \$2,400 remains unreconciled.

4. causation. Turn 8. Causation connects the delivery event to the claimed consequence; correct arithmetic alone does not establish that connection.

5. contemporaneous records. Turn 10. Contemporaneous records were made near the event; retain them and distinguish later analysis instead of rewriting the evidence.

6. notice provisions. Turn 12. Notice provisions govern contractual notification requirements; a generic email cannot be assumed to satisfy the actual terms.

7. entitlement. Turn 14. Entitlement is the right to a remedy; identifying it as unreviewed neither proves it nor necessarily abandons it.

8. Quantum. Turn 16. Quantum concerns the monetary amount, separate from whether the claimant has a right to a remedy.

9. mitigation. Turn 18. Mitigation concerns limiting adverse effects; report actual steps without inventing their success or legal consequences.

10. Settlement authority. Turn 20. Settlement authority permits agreeing a resolution for a party; preparing records does not confer that power.

F Transfer conversation

Page 75

1. three

Coordinator: "The delivery variance is three working days."

Day 7 minus Day 4 is a difference of three working days.

2. 900

Manager: "The reported labor amount is \$900."

Nine hundred dollars is the supplied reported additional labor amount.

3. unassessed

Coordinator: "The effect on project completion remains unassessed."

The brief says the completion impact has not been reviewed.

4. entitlement

Manager: "The right to a remedy is the entitlement question."

Entitlement concerns the right to a remedy, separate from timing and amount.

08

09 Conversation answers

A clash report is not an instruction to move a duct

E Extended conversation

Pages 76-77

- 1. federated model.** Turn 2. The federated model combines discipline models for coordination; its result depends on the versions and alignment loaded.
- 2. shared coordinates.** Turn 4. Shared coordinates align the discipline models; a misplaced model can create apparent intersections that do not reflect the intended geometry.
- 3. geometric clash.** Turn 8. A geometric clash is an intersection of modeled elements; it does not by itself establish an installed defect or the correct remedy.
- 4. viewpoint.** Turn 12. The viewpoint and element references locate the model issue so the assigned reviewer can inspect the same conflict.
- 5. fabrication release.** Turn 16. Fabrication release requires the applicable authorized information; a proposed model adjustment does not provide it.
- 6. resolution status.** Turn 20. Resolution status records the issue's verified outcome, distinct from an assigned reviewer or a proposed reroute.

F Transfer exchange

Page 78

1. M04

Coordinator: The current services revision to verify is M04.

M04 is the issued current version; the screenshot used older M03.

2. alignment

Engineer: First verify model alignment before interpreting the apparent intersection.

Unverified alignment can affect where the combined model displays its elements.

3. Rosa

Coordinator: The assigned design reviewer is Rosa.

Rosa accepted the review responsibility, not approval of a particular reroute.

4. approved

Engineer: The proposed reroute is not yet approved.

The supplied case explicitly leaves design authorization unresolved despite the assigned reviewer.

Background reading: [buildingSMART: BIM Collaboration Format](#). The conversation is an original fictional teaching case.

10 Conversation answers

The color sample did not approve a different product

E Extended conversation

Pages 79-80

1. review scope. Turn 2. The review scope was color only; it did not establish acceptance of a different panel product or technical properties.

2. substitution proposal. Turn 4. A substitution proposal identifies an alternative to the specified product and provides information for the required review.

3. applicability. Turn 8. Applicability asks whether the evidence covers the exact proposed product and configuration, not merely the same manufacturer.

4. quoted lead-time saving. Turn 12. The quoted comparison is six weeks versus four; no reserved production slot establishes an actual delivery commitment.

5. commercial commitment. Turn 16. A purchase order may create an obligation; adding a condition does not establish that Mina has authority or no liability.

6. decision record. Turn 20. The decision record establishes the authorized outcome and its scope; a prior color selection cannot stand in for it.

F Transfer exchange

Page 81

1. C

Coordinator: The sample acceptance concerns finish C only.

Finish C is the accepted color; that decision does not approve Q12.

2. Q12

Architect: The proposed alternative is product Q12.

Q12 is the supplier's proposed replacement, not the specified Q10.

3. two

Coordinator: The quoted lead-time difference is two weeks.

Five quoted weeks minus three quoted weeks gives two, not a guaranteed delivery saving.

4. pending

Architect: Technical acceptance of the substitution remains pending.

The supplied facts contain no completed technical decision or substitution approval.

10

Background reading: **AIA: construction scope, substitutions, and payment.** The conversation is an original fictional teaching case.

11 Conversation answers

Cumulative value is not this month's payment

E Extended conversation

Pages 82-83

1. cumulative valuation. Turn 2. The valuation is the total eligible completed and stored amount to date, not automatically the amount payable in the current application.

2. retainage. Turn 4. Retainage is the specified withheld portion: five percent of the eligible \$100,000 total equals \$5,000.

3. current amount requested. Turn 6. The current request is \$95,000 after retainage less \$60,000 previously certified, giving \$35,000 before certification.

4. previous certificates. Turn 8. The stated calculation deducts prior certified amounts, not cash received; the unpaid balance is tracked separately rather than certified twice.

5. double counting. Turn 12. Counting the same material as both installed work and presently stored would overstate the eligible cumulative amount.

6. valuation date. Turn 18. The valuation date identifies the cut-off for work and materials included, supporting comparison with the relevant billing period.

F Transfer exchange

Page 84

1. 80,000

Surveyor: Total eligible completed and stored value is \$80,000.

Seventy thousand plus ten thousand gives eighty thousand cumulative eligible value.

2. 4,000

Coordinator: The stated retainage is \$4,000.

Five percent of eighty thousand equals four thousand retained.

3. 26,000

Surveyor: The new request, before certification, is \$26,000.

Eighty thousand less four thousand retainage less fifty thousand previously certified equals twenty-six thousand.

4. 5,000

Coordinator: The earlier certified but unpaid balance is \$5,000.

Fifty thousand certified minus forty-five thousand paid leaves five thousand to track separately.

11

Background reading: [AIA: progress-payment calculation and reconciliation](#). The conversation is an original fictional teaching case.

Find the move you need

Use these as precise language models. Replace details only when you know the actual facts, authority, and agreed conditions.

01 Design Intent and Client Requirements

Clarify a broad adjective: When you say flexible, which activities do you need?

Quantify presentation needs: The presentation arrangement needs twenty-four seats in rows.

Specify the listening need: Remote participants need to hear questions throughout the room.

Full phrase set: pages 7-8 | Dialogue: pages 10-11

02 Drawings, Specifications, and RFIs

Locate the issue: The discrepancy concerns the same wall in Room 205.

Confirm document status: Both references are in the current project issue.

Separate a proposal: Our suggested option is not an approved instruction.

Full phrase set: pages 16-17 | Dialogue: pages 19-20

03 Change Orders and Cost Control

Correct the minutes: The client requested pricing, not construction.

Explain the conditional total: If accepted, that proposal would bring the sum to one hundred eleven thousand two hundred dollars.

Check what is missing: Which items are excluded from this quotation?

Full phrase set: pages 25-26 | Dialogue: pages 28-29

04 Schedule, Sequencing, and Critical Path

Identify the reference: The baseline places testing on Day 4.

Preserve the duration: Installation still requires two full working days.

Keep the reference intact: Retain the baseline and show the revised forecast separately.

Full phrase set: pages 34-35 | Dialogue: pages 37-38

Keep the conversation productive

Use these as precise language models. Replace details only when you know the actual facts, authority, and agreed conditions.

05 Site Safety and Toolbox Talks

Name the affected activity: The panel-cutting task in Zone B is stopped.

Request qualified review: Please obtain the task-specific assessment and controls.

State the restart boundary: The required clarification and authorization are still pending.

Full phrase set: pages 43-44 | Dialogue: pages 46-47

06 Permitting, Inspections, and Code Issues

Correct the broad claim: Fully approved is not supported by this inspection record.

Describe the evidence: Photographs have been submitted for the two outstanding items.

Separate occupancy: No occupancy permission is issued in the supplied case.

Full phrase set: pages 52-53 | Dialogue: pages 55-56

07 Quality, Punch List, and Closeout

State the list scope: This register covers eight Level 2 punch-list items.

Preserve the open status: Those five items remain open under our process.

State the next commitment: I will provide a status update at 16:00 Friday.

Full phrase set: pages 61-62 | Dialogue: pages 64-65

08 Claims, Disputes, and Documentation

State the event: Delivery occurred at the end of working Day 11.

Avoid a completion inference: The effect on project completion has not been assessed.

Keep entitlement open: Entitlement to time or payment remains under review.

Full phrase set: pages 70-71 | Dialogue: pages 73-74

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

acceleration assess acceleration options	33
acceptance criteria apply acceptance criteria	59
acceptance record obtain an acceptance record	50
accessibility integrate accessibility requirements	6
acoustic performance assess acoustic performance	6
activity duration verify the activity duration	32
adjacency test an adjacency requirement	6
administrative control communicate administrative controls	41
adopted code verify the adopted code	50
approval scope state the approval scope	51
approved adjustment record an approved adjustment	23
asset register populate the asset register	60
audiovisual (AV) system coordinate the AV system	6
authority having jurisdiction (AHJ) identify the authority having jurisdiction	50
authorization to proceed verify authorization to proceed	24
baseline schedule retain the baseline schedule	32
briefing record maintain the briefing record	42
calendar basis state the calendar basis	33
callout follow the callout	14
causation establish causation	68
certificate of occupancy (CO) check the certificate of occupancy	51
change order execute a change order	23
change register maintain the change register	24
changeover time set a changeover target	5

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

chronology prepare a chronology	68
circulation maintain clear circulation	5
claim substantiate a claim	68
clarification obtain written clarification	15
client brief develop the client brief	5
closeout register maintain the closeout register	59
code compliance demonstrate code compliance	51
commissioning coordinate commissioning records	60
commitment distinguish a cost commitment	24
concurrent delay assess concurrent delay	68
conditional approval preserve conditional approval terms	51
constraint identify a schedule constraint	33
construction change directive check a construction change directive	24
contemporaneous record preserve contemporaneous records	68
contingency distinguish the contingency	24
contract sum state the current contract sum	23
controlled distribution maintain controlled distribution	15
correction notice respond to a correction notice	50
correspondence register update the correspondence register	69
cost breakdown request a cost breakdown	23
cost reconciliation complete cost reconciliation	69
critical path review the critical path	32
critical-path analysis update the critical-path analysis	33
daily report consult the daily report	69

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

data date state the data date	32
deductive change price a deductive change	23
defects liability period verify the defects liability period	60
deficiency record a deficiency	59
delay event document a delay event	68
delivery docket retain the delivery docket	69
design constraint identify a design constraint	6
design coordination coordinate the design response	15
design intent explain the design intent	5
design professional consult the design professional	51
detail reference the detail	14
discrepancy document the discrepancy	14
dispute resolution follow the dispute-resolution process	69
disputed amount identify the disputed amount	69
disruption distinguish disruption from delay	68
document precedence establish document precedence	14
drawing reference cite the drawing reference	14
dust extraction review dust extraction requirements	41
egress review egress requirements	5
elevation compare the elevation	14
engineering control verify engineering controls	41
entitlement assess entitlement	68
equipment guarding verify equipment guarding	42
exclusion identify a pricing exclusion	24

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

exclusion zone identify the exclusion zone	42
exposure assess worker exposure	41
extension of time distinguish an extension of time	33
final completion verify final completion	60
finish schedule consult the finish schedule	14
finish-to-start relationship model a finish-to-start relationship	32
forecast date revise the forecast date	32
free float distinguish free float	32
functional requirement define a functional requirement	5
handover package assemble the handover package	60
hazard identification complete hazard identification	41
hierarchy of controls apply the hierarchy of controls	41
inspection finding address an inspection finding	50
inspection record consult the inspection record	50
inspection status report inspection status	51
isolation follow the isolation procedure	42
issue status check the issue status	14
job hazard analysis (JHA) review the job hazard analysis	41
jurisdiction identify the jurisdiction	51
labor allocation verify labor allocation	69
labor allowance review the labor allowance	23
lead time confirm the lead time	32
liability distinguish alleged liability	69
local amendment check local amendments	50

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

lookahead schedule update the lookahead schedule	32
markup explain the markup	24
material cost verify material costs	23
material sample submit a material sample	15
method statement consult the approved method statement	41
microphone coverage assess microphone coverage	6
milestone track the testing milestone	33
mitigation document mitigation measures	68
mock-up compare with the approved mock-up	60
near miss report a near miss	42
net addition calculate the net addition	23
noise assessment obtain a noise assessment	42
notice provision review the notice provisions	68
occupancy permission verify occupancy permission	51
occupant load verify the occupant load	5
operation and maintenance manual provide operation and maintenance manuals	60
outstanding item track an outstanding item	50
pending exposure report pending exposure	24
performance target state a performance target	6
permit verify the permit scope	50
permit closeout coordinate permit closeout	51
personal protective equipment (PPE) specify task-appropriate PPE	41
plan review respond to plan-review comments	50
power provision coordinate power provision	6

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

predecessor identify the predecessor	32
pricing assumption state a pricing assumption	24
procurement hold maintain the procurement hold	15
productivity test productivity assumptions	33
prolongation assess prolongation effects	68
proposal request issue a proposal request	23
proposed amount separate the proposed amount	23
public-use restriction communicate a public-use restriction	51
punch list update the punch list	59
quantity takeoff check the quantity takeoff	23
quantum assess quantum	68
quotation validity check quotation validity	24
reconfigurable furniture specify reconfigurable furniture	5
record drawing update record drawings	60
recovery plan evaluate a recovery plan	33
rectification report rectification	59
reinspection request a reinspection	50
repeat-back request a repeat-back	42
reported complete distinguish reported complete	59
request for information (RFI) raise an RFI	14
reservation of rights seek review of a reservation of rights	69
resource availability verify resource availability	33
response date distinguish the response date	15
restart condition state the restart conditions	42

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

resubmittal prepare a resubmittal	50
reverberation evaluate reverberation	6
revision verify the revision	14
rework track rework	59
RFI log update the RFI log	15
risk assessment review the risk assessment	41
safety data sheet (SDS) consult the safety data sheet	42
schedule variance explain the schedule variance	33
scope change assess a scope change	23
seating arrangement compare seating arrangements	5
section review the section	14
sequence preserve the required sequence	33
settlement authority verify settlement authority	69
shop drawing review the shop drawing	15
sightline check presentation sightlines	6
sign-off obtain the required sign-off	60
site induction complete the site induction	42
snagging carry out snagging	59
space planning review the space planning	5
specification review the specification	14
speech intelligibility improve speech intelligibility	6
stop-work instruction communicate a stop-work instruction	42
storage allowance include a storage allowance	6
submittal track the submittal	15

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

substantial completion determine substantial completion	60
substantiation provide claim substantiation	69
substitution request a substitution	15
successor identify the successor	32
superseded document identify a superseded document	15
supporting evidence attach supporting evidence	51
task briefing clarify the task briefing	41
task competence verify task competence	42
temporary occupancy verify temporary occupancy conditions	51
theater-style seating propose theater-style seating	5
time bar obtain advice on a time bar	69
time impact assess the time impact	24
tolerance verify the specified tolerance	60
toolbox talk deliver a toolbox talk	41
total float assess total float	32
traceability preserve decision traceability	15
trade contractor coordinate with the trade contractor	59
verification evidence link verification evidence	59
verified closed mark an item verified closed	59
warranty check warranty terms	60
workfront release a workfront	33
working day specify working days	24
workmanship assess workmanship	59
workshop layout develop a workshop layout	5

Original cases. Clear boundaries.

These are original fictional teaching conversations, not transcripts of real workers. Names, figures, organizations, and incidents are invented. Sources support terminology and communication aims, not the fictional results or an endorsement of this book.

[1] AIA Contract Documents. G716-2004: Request for Information instructions.

[Open the original source](#)

Terminology background for referenced questions and documented clarification. No AIA form is reproduced; the RFI cases and wording are original. Checked 30 September 2026.

[2] AIA Contract Documents. G701-2017: Change Order overview.

[Open the original source](#)

Background on documenting changes to scope, price, and time. The approval arrangements and figures in this book are fictional, not universal contract rules. Checked 30 September 2026.

[3] Occupational Safety and Health Administration. Personal Protective Equipment: Construction.

[Open the original source](#)

U.S. safety terminology background. The toolbox dialogue is about requesting qualified clarification, not selecting protective equipment or providing a work method. Checked 30 September 2026.

[4] AIA Contract Documents. G704-2017: Certificate of Substantial Completion instructions.

[Open the original source](#)

Background on closeout terminology and outstanding work. Contractual substantial completion is not presented as a substitute for local occupancy permission. Checked 30 September 2026.

Phil Stilwell

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